

UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Examination - General Studies Paper I

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 2 Hours | Maximum Marks: 200

Quick Key

1-A	2-B	3-C	4-D	5-A	6-B	7-C	8-D	9-A	10-B
11-C	12-D	13-A	14-B	15-C	16-D	17-A	18-B	19-C	20-D
21-A	22-B	23-C	24-D	25-A	26-B	27-C	28-D	29-A	30-B
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41-A	42-B	43-C	44-D	45-A	46-B	47-C	48-D	49-A	50-B
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Detailed solutions

Q1. Answer: A | Polity

Which statement best describes institutional features absent from India's Article 368 process?

A. There is no referendum, no special constituent convention and no joint sitting to resolve House disagreement. - CORRECT: Correct: India entrusts amendment to Parliament and, selectively, State legislatures without direct popular ratification or a separate amending assembly.

B. A referendum is mandatory, but a constituent convention is optional. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Article 368 contains no referendum stage of any kind.

C. A joint sitting is available, though State ratification is not. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Joint sitting is unavailable, while State ratification is indispensable for the listed proviso subjects.

D. A special constituent body must approve every amendment before Parliament votes. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The ordinary Houses of Parliament exercise the constituent function under special constitutional rules.

Method / explanation: India entrusts amendment to Parliament and, selectively, State legislatures without direct popular ratification or a separate amending assembly.

Trap: Do not confuse Parliament acting in a constituent capacity with the creation of a separate constituent body.

Q2. Answer: B | Polity

Article 243ZJ board Which statement correctly describes Article 243ZJ?

A. It requires exactly twenty-one elected directors in every society - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The proposition 'It requires exactly twenty-one elected directors in every society' changes the controlling category, condition or legal source. Article 243ZJ uses a maximum of twenty-one, a five-year elected term, qualified SC/ST and women reservation, up to two expert co-options and separate treatment of functional directors.

B. It sets a ceiling of twenty-one directors, a five-year term and qualified reservation/co-option rules - CORRECT: Correct. Article 243ZJ uses a maximum of twenty-one, a five-year elected term, qualified SC/ST and women reservation, up to two expert co-options and separate treatment of functional directors.

C. It gives every co-opted expert a right to become an office bearer - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The proposition 'It gives every co-opted expert a right to become an office bearer' changes the controlling category, condition or legal source. Article 243ZJ uses a maximum of twenty-one, a five-year elected term, qualified SC/ST and women reservation, up to two expert co-options and separate treatment of functional directors.

D. It fixes a three-year term and bars functional directors - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The proposition 'It fixes a three-year term and bars functional directors' changes the controlling category, condition or legal source. Article 243ZJ uses a maximum of twenty-one, a five-year elected term, qualified SC/ST and women reservation, up to two expert co-options and separate treatment of functional directors.

Method / explanation: Correct. Article 243ZJ uses a maximum of twenty-one, a five-year elected term, qualified SC/ST and women reservation, up to two expert co-options and separate treatment of functional directors.

Trap: Ceiling, qualification and exclusion rules matter more than the shorthand '21 members'.

Q3. Answer: C | Polity

Article 227 Which statement best describes Article 227?

A. It is limited to issuing habeas corpus. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The option collapses a distinction preserved by the governing rule: Article 227 supplies judicial and administrative superintendence with an express Armed Forces exception. Therefore 'It is limited to issuing habeas corpus.' introduces a wrong actor, source, threshold, scope or consequence.

B. It applies only to executive departments. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The stated actor, source or consequence fails when tested against: Article 227 supplies judicial and administrative superintendence with an express Armed Forces exception. Therefore 'It applies only to executive departments.' introduces a wrong actor, source, threshold, scope or consequence.

C. It gives superintendence over territorial courts and tribunals, except Armed-Forces-law forums. - CORRECT: Correct. This choice matches the controlling proposition: Article 227 supplies judicial and administrative superintendence with an express Armed Forces exception. Therefore 'It gives superintendence over territorial courts and tribunals, except Armed-Forces-law forums.' states the operative position.

D. It is a statutory appeal from every order. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. This formulation overstates, understates or misattributes the rule: Article 227 supplies judicial and administrative superintendence with an express Armed Forces exception. Therefore 'It is a statutory appeal from every order.' introduces a wrong actor, source, threshold, scope or consequence.

Method / explanation: Correct. This choice matches the controlling proposition: Article 227 supplies judicial and administrative superintendence with an express Armed Forces exception. Therefore 'It gives superintendence over territorial courts and tribunals, except Armed-Forces-law forums.' states the operative position.

Trap: Superintendence is wide in source but restrained in exercise.

Q4. Answer: D | Polity

Which statement about Article 44 is correct?

A. It applies only to criminal law, which remains non-uniform. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "It applies only to criminal law, which remains non-uniform." fails against the controlling rule. Article 44 is a non-justiciable DPSP. Entry 5 supplies legislative competence in family/personal-law fields.

B. It directs courts to enact a uniform code when Parliament fails. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "It directs courts to enact a uniform code when Parliament fails." fails against the controlling rule. Article 44 is a non-justiciable DPSP. Entry 5 supplies legislative competence in family/personal-law fields.

C. It is a Fundamental Duty enforceable through Article 32. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "It is a Fundamental Duty enforceable through Article 32." fails against the controlling rule. Article 44 is a non-justiciable DPSP. Entry 5 supplies legislative competence in family/personal-law fields.

D. It directs the State to endeavour to secure a UCC for citizens throughout India; personal-law subjects lie in Concurrent List Entry 5. - CORRECT: Correct: Article 44 is a non-justiciable DPSP. Entry 5 supplies legislative competence in family/personal-law fields. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Method / explanation: Article 44 is a non-justiciable DPSP. Entry 5 supplies legislative competence in family/personal-law fields. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Trap: Article 44 states a State endeavour; it neither creates an Article 32 remedy nor transfers legislation to courts.

Q5. Answer: A | Polity

Which statement correctly describes Article 38(2)?

A. It directs the State to minimise inequalities in income and endeavour to eliminate inequalities in status, facilities and opportunities among individuals and groups. - CORRECT: Correct: The Forty-fourth Amendment inserted Article 38(2), and its reach extends beyond income to status, facilities and opportunities among individuals and groups in different areas or vocations. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

B. It is an original 1950 clause limited to inequality between citizens and non-citizens. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "It is an original 1950 clause limited to inequality between citizens and non-citizens." fails against the controlling rule. The Forty-fourth

Amendment inserted Article 38(2), and its reach extends beyond income to status, facilities and opportunities among individuals and groups in different areas or vocations.

C. It creates an immediately enforceable individual claim to identical income. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "It creates an immediately enforceable individual claim to identical income." fails against the controlling rule. The Forty-fourth Amendment inserted Article 38(2), and its reach extends beyond income to status, facilities and opportunities among individuals and groups in different areas or vocations.

D. It was inserted by the Forty-second Amendment together with Article 39A. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "It was inserted by the Forty-second Amendment together with Article 39A." fails against the controlling rule. The Forty-fourth Amendment inserted Article 38(2), and its reach extends beyond income to status, facilities and opportunities among individuals and groups in different areas or vocations.

Method / explanation: The Forty-fourth Amendment inserted Article 38(2), and its reach extends beyond income to status, facilities and opportunities among individuals and groups in different areas or vocations. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Trap: Article 38(2) reaches status, facilities and opportunities as well as income.

Q6. Answer: B | Polity

Consider the following regarding sections 12 and 13 of the Legal Services Authorities Act: 1. A woman is a section 12 category irrespective of the general income route. 2. Every OBC member is independently listed as a category. 3. A person in custody is a listed category. 4. The authority must be satisfied that there is a prima facie case. Which statements are correct?

A. 2, 3 and 4 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "2, 3 and 4 only" fails against the controlling rule. OBC status by itself is not listed. The Act combines category/income eligibility with prima facie screening.

B. 1, 3 and 4 only - CORRECT: Correct: OBC status by itself is not listed. The Act combines category/income eligibility with prima facie screening. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

C. 1, 2, 3 and 4 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "1, 2, 3 and 4" fails against the controlling rule. OBC status by itself is not listed. The Act combines category/income eligibility with prima facie screening.

D. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the proposition "1 and 2 only" fails against the controlling rule. OBC status by itself is not listed. The Act combines category/income eligibility with prima facie screening.

Method / explanation: OBC status by itself is not listed. The Act combines category/income eligibility with prima facie screening. This option states the controlling rule without adding a wider immunity or remedy.

Trap: Section 12 category eligibility and section 13 prima-facie screening are distinct statutory questions.

Q7. Answer: C | Polity

With reference to the constitutional history of Fundamental Duties, which statement is correct?

A. The 42nd Amendment enacted only the eight duties proposed by the Committee. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The enacted list was not confined to the Committee's eight recommendations; Article 51A originally contained ten clauses.

B. The original Constitution contained ten duties in Part IV. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The Constitution of 1950 contained no separate Part IVA or citizen-duty catalogue.

C. The Swaran Singh Committee recommended eight duties, while the 42nd Amendment enacted ten. - CORRECT: Correct: The Committee proposed eight duties, but the Forty-second Amendment selected and expanded the scheme into ten constitutional clauses.

D. The 86th Amendment inserted Part IVA for the first time. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The Eighty-sixth Amendment added clause (k); Part IVA had already existed since 1976.

Method / explanation: The Committee proposed eight duties, but the Forty-second Amendment selected and expanded the scheme into ten constitutional clauses.

Trap: The numbers belong to different stages: eight recommended, ten enacted, eleven now.

Q8. Answer: D | Polity

India-Britain difference Consider the following: 1. India is a republic; Britain a constitutional monarchy. 2. India has a written supreme Constitution; Britain follows parliamentary sovereignty. 3. India's PM may be from either House; Britain's PM is by convention from the Commons. Which is correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Statements 1 and 2 are true, but statement 3 is also a valid India-Britain distinction.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. It omits India's republican headship while correctly including the other two differences.

C. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect. It ignores the written supreme Constitution and the House-membership convention.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - CORRECT: Correct. Republican headship, constitutional supremacy and eligibility of an Indian PM from either House distinguish the Indian adaptation.

Method / explanation: Correct. Republican headship, constitutional supremacy and eligibility of an Indian PM from either House distinguish the Indian adaptation.

Trap: India borrowed responsible government, not monarchy or Westminster parliamentary sovereignty.

Q9. Answer: A | Polity

Which statement about Articles 27 and 28 is correct?

A. Article 27 bars a specifically appropriated religion-promoting tax, while Article 28 distinguishes wholly State-maintained, trust-administered and aided or recognised institutions. - CORRECT: Correct: the option preserves the fiscal-purpose test and all three institutional categories in Article 28.

B. Article 27 prohibits every regulatory fee connected with any religious institution. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: tax purpose and appropriation must be distinguished from a regulatory fee or neutral general levy.

C. Article 28 forbids academic study about religion in every educational institution. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: objective education about religions is not automatically the religious instruction prohibited by the clause.

D. Article 28 permits compulsory religious instruction in every aided institution without consent. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Article 28(3) protects against compelled attendance without the required consent in covered institutions.

Method / explanation: the option preserves the fiscal-purpose test and all three institutional categories in Article 28.

Trap: Tax versus fee and instruction versus academic study are separate close-option distinctions.

Q10. Answer: B | Polity

With reference to Articles 1 and 3, which statement is most accurate?

A. Every alteration of a State boundary requires that State legislature's consent. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. The President must refer the proposal for views, but the affected legislature's consent does not bind Parliament.

B. India is a Union of States, and Parliament may reorganise States after seeking the affected State legislature's views. - CORRECT: Correct. The Union is not a compact with secession, while territorial change follows the consultative Article 3 process.

C. Article 3 gives States a constitutional right to secede after consultation. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Article 1 and the constitutional design reject a unilateral State right to leave the Union.

D. A law under Article 3 must always satisfy the special amendment procedure in Article 368. - INCORRECT: Incorrect. Article 4 states that supplemental territorial provisions under Articles 2 and 3 are not Article 368 amendments.

Method / explanation: Correct. The Union is not a compact with secession, while territorial change follows the consultative Article 3 process.

Trap: State consultation under Article 3 is mandatory as a step, but State approval is not a constitutional veto.

Q11. Answer: C | Polity

Article 142 The safest statement of Article 142 is:

A. it authorises permanent law-making whenever equity favours it. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Article 142 is remedial, not a general legislative competence.

B. it is confined to advisory references. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the power operates in causes or matters before the Court generally.

C. it permits complete-justice orders in a pending cause but cannot violate Fundamental Rights or supplant substantive law. - CORRECT: Correct: Prem Chand Garg and Supreme Court Bar Association supply constitutional and substantive-law limits.

D. it allows any statutory prohibition to be ignored. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: complete justice cannot become a licence to defeat governing law.

Method / explanation: Prem Chand Garg and Supreme Court Bar Association supply constitutional and substantive-law limits.

Trap: Use 'supplement, not supplant' and avoid calling Article 142 unlimited.

Q12. Answer: D | Polity

Consider the following statements about introduction of a Constitution Amendment Bill: 1. It may be introduced in either House. 2. It may be introduced by a private member. 3. It needs prior Presidential recommendation. Which are correct?

A. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: A private member may introduce the Bill, but prior Presidential recommendation is not a constitutional condition.

B. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 3 wrongly imports a recommendation requirement from other legislative categories.

C. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: This omits the valid private-member route recognised for amendment Bills.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: Either House and either ministerial or private-member sponsorship are permitted.

Method / explanation: Either House and either ministerial or private-member sponsorship are permitted.

Trap: Separate the absent recommendation at introduction from the President's mandatory assent at the end.

Q13. Answer: A | Economy

Which institutional statement is correct?

A. RBI regulates payment systems while NPCI operates specified retail systems such as UPI - CORRECT: Correct: regulator and operator are distinct.

B. NPCI legislates the Payment and Settlement Systems Act - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Parliament enacted the statute and RBI exercises regulatory powers.

C. A TPAP holds every user's bank deposit - INCORRECT: Incorrect: deposits remain with banks.

D. A PSP bank is the same legal entity as every app it supports - INCORRECT: Incorrect: a TPAP and its partner PSP bank have separate roles.

Method / explanation: regulator and operator are distinct.

Trap: Never merge regulator, operator, bank and front-end application.

Q14. Answer: B | Economy

Which dated e-NAM statement is accurate?

A. 1,656 means every mandi in India was integrated. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: It is a programme count, not the national universe. The option states: 1,656 means every mandi in India was integrated.

B. A PIB backgrounder dated 13 April 2026 reported 1,656 integrated mandis across 23 States and 4 UTs by March 2026. - CORRECT: Correct: The claim retains source, date and denominator. The option states: A PIB backgrounder dated 13 April 2026 reported 1,656 integrated mandis across 23 States and 4 UTs by March 2026.

C. The count proves every registered farmer traded. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Registration or integration does not prove use. The option states: The count proves every registered farmer traded.

D. The count is an undated permanent statutory threshold. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Administrative counts change over time. The option states: The count is an undated permanent statutory threshold.

Method / explanation: The claim retains source, date and denominator. The option states: A PIB backgrounder dated 13 April 2026 reported 1,656 integrated mandis across 23 States and 4 UTs by March 2026.

Trap: Platform reach is not transaction depth.

Q15. Answer: C | Economy

Which statement about subsidies is legally sound?

A. Every government programme is a prohibited subsidy - INCORRECT: Incorrect: General public services or non-specific measures need not satisfy the legal subsidy test. Option text: Every government programme is a prohibited subsidy

B. Every export remission is prohibited - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Remission that does not exceed embedded taxes can differ from an export-contingent net subsidy. Option text: Every export remission is prohibited

C. WTO treatment depends on design, specificity, agreement and effects - CORRECT: Correct: This is correct because financial contribution, benefit, specificity and applicable disciplines must be established. Option text: WTO treatment depends on design, specificity, agreement and effects

D. Services subsidies are disciplined identically by the SCM Agreement - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The SCM Agreement's core disciplines concern trade in goods. Option text: Services subsidies are disciplined identically by the SCM Agreement

Method / explanation: This is correct because financial contribution, benefit, specificity and applicable disciplines must be established. Option text: WTO treatment depends on design, specificity, agreement and effects

Trap: Classify the measure before declaring WTO inconsistency. Focus: which statement about subsidies is legally sound.

Q16. Answer: D | Economy

Which statement accurately dates the 10,000-FPO scheme?

A. Launched under the repealed 2020 farm laws and ended in 2021. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The scheme is institutionally separate from those laws. The option states: Launched under the repealed 2020 farm laws and ended in 2021.

B. It makes every FPO profitable by statute. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Commercial success is not guaranteed. The option states: It makes every FPO profitable by statute.

C. It requires every FPO to be an APMC. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: FPO and APMC are different entities. The option states: It requires every FPO to be an APMC.

D. Launched 29 February 2020; the target was reported achieved on 28 February 2025, with scheme support structured through 2027-28. - CORRECT: Correct: The dates separate launch, formation milestone and support horizon. The option states: Launched 29 February 2020; the target was reported achieved on 28 February 2025, with scheme support structured through 2027-28.

Method / explanation: The dates separate launch, formation milestone and support horizon. The option states: Launched 29 February 2020; the target was reported achieved on 28 February 2025, with scheme support structured through 2027-28.

Trap: Formation target is not a viability outcome.

Q17. Answer: A | Economy

Which status pair is correct at the 9 September 2026 cutoff?

A. UK CETA in force; India-New Zealand FTA signed but awaiting procedures - CORRECT: Correct: This is correct: UK CETA entered into force on 15 July 2026, while the New Zealand release says entry follows domestic procedures and ratification. Option text: UK CETA in force; India-New Zealand FTA signed but awaiting procedures

B. India is an RCEP member; EU FTA is in force - INCORRECT: Incorrect: India did not join RCEP and this package assigns no EU entry-into-force date. Option text: India is an RCEP member; EU FTA is in force

C. EFTA TEPA is unsigned; Oman CEPA is only under negotiation - INCORRECT: Incorrect: EFTA TEPA entered into force on 1 October 2025 and Oman CEPA on 1 June 2026. Option text: EFTA TEPA is unsigned; Oman CEPA is only under negotiation

D. Australia ECTA is not operative; UAE CEPA begins in 2027 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Australia ECTA and UAE CEPA have operated since December and May 2022 respectively. Option text: Australia ECTA is not operative; UAE CEPA begins in 2027

Method / explanation: This is correct: UK CETA entered into force on 15 July 2026, while the New Zealand release says entry follows domestic procedures and ratification. Option text: UK CETA in force; India-New Zealand FTA signed but awaiting procedures

Trap: Concluded, signed and in force are not synonyms. Focus: which status pair is correct at the 9 September 2026 cutoff.

Q18. Answer: B | Economy

Which statement correctly bounds SVAMITVA?

A. It surveys every agricultural field nationwide. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Agricultural fields are not its universal scope. The option states: It surveys every agricultural field nationwide.

B. It maps rural abadi areas and supports State-issued property cards through survey and objection processes. - CORRECT: Correct: SVAMITVA's primary spatial focus is inhabited village abadi property. The option states: It maps rural abadi areas and supports State-issued property cards through survey and objection processes.

C. Its card is uniformly an indefeasible Union title deed. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Legal effect depends on State law. The option states: Its card is uniformly an indefeasible Union title deed.

D. It replaces cadastral and revenue law in every State. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The scheme operates with, not above, State legal systems. The option states: It replaces cadastral and revenue law in every State.

Method / explanation: SVAMITVA's primary spatial focus is inhabited village abadi property. The option states: It maps rural abadi areas and supports State-issued property cards through survey and objection processes.

Trap: A property card is not automatically conclusive title.

Q19. Answer: C | Economy

Which statement about Per Drop More Crop is current?

A. It is the major-dam component of PMKSY. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: AIBP addresses major and medium projects. The option states: It is the major-dam component of PMKSY.

B. It was repealed with the 2020 farm laws. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The farm-law repeal is unrelated. The option states: It was repealed with the 2020 farm laws.

C. It supports micro-irrigation and has been implemented under RKVY from 2022-23. - CORRECT: Correct: The policy objective continues under a changed administrative umbrella. The option states: It supports micro-irrigation and has been implemented under RKVY from 2022-23.

D. It is a crop-insurance premium subsidy. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: PMFBY is the insurance scheme. The option states: It is a crop-insurance premium subsidy.

Method / explanation: The policy objective continues under a changed administrative umbrella. The option states: It supports micro-irrigation and has been implemented under RKVY from 2022-23.

Trap: Do not freeze the older PMKSY placement.

Q20. Answer: D | Economy

Which PMFBY premium pair is correct under official 2026 terms?

A. Kharif 5%; Rabi 5%; horticulture 1.5%. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The categories are reversed. The option states: Kharif 5%; Rabi 5%; horticulture 1.5%.

B. One uniform 2% rate for every crop. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Rates are not uniform. The option states: One uniform 2% rate for every crop.

C. These percentages are claim-payment rates. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Premium share and indemnity differ. The option states: These percentages are claim-payment rates.

D. Kharif 2%; Rabi food/oilseed 1.5%; annual commercial/horticultural 5% maximum farmer shares. - CORRECT: Correct: The seasonal/crop categories define farmer premium caps. The option states: Kharif 2%; Rabi food/oilseed 1.5%; annual commercial/horticultural 5% maximum farmer shares.

Method / explanation: The seasonal/crop categories define farmer premium caps. The option states: Kharif 2%; Rabi food/oilseed 1.5%; annual commercial/horticultural 5% maximum farmer shares.

Trap: Premium percentage is not claim percentage.

Q21. Answer: A | Economy

Which statement correctly defines an FPO?

A. It is a farmer-member producer organisation that may use more than one eligible legal form. - CORRECT: Correct: FPO is a functional membership umbrella. The option states: It is a farmer-member producer organisation that may use more than one eligible legal form.

B. It is necessarily a Producer Company only. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Producer Company is one legal form. The option states: It is necessarily a Producer Company only.

C. It is any trader association registered in a mandi. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Trader associations are not farmer producer organisations. The option states: It is any trader association registered in a mandi.

D. It is a government department purchasing MSP crops. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Procurement agencies have a different role. The option states: It is a government department purchasing MSP crops.

Method / explanation: FPO is a functional membership umbrella. The option states: It is a farmer-member producer organisation that may use more than one eligible legal form.

Trap: FPO and FPC are not universal synonyms.

Q22. Answer: B | Economy

Consider the following: 1. Charged expenditure may be discussed. 2. It is not submitted to vote. 3. It needs no appropriation. Which is correct?

A. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 1 alone omits the equally correct non-votability rule.

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: Statements 1 and 2 correctly preserve discussion without vote.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Statement 3 is wrong because charged sums are included in appropriation.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: All three cannot be correct because appropriation is still required.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 correctly preserve discussion without vote.

Trap: Do not replace the tested rule - 1 and 2 only - with a neighbouring legal, accounting, vintage or institutional category.

Q23. Answer: C | Economy

Which statement about fertiliser subsidy is correct?

A. Urea is included in NBS exactly like DAP. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Urea remains outside NBS. The option states: Urea is included in NBS exactly like DAP.

B. All P&K MRPs are statutorily fixed like urea. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: P&K MRP is decontrolled subject to policy oversight. The option states: All P&K MRPs are statutorily fixed like urea.

C. Urea has controlled MRP under a separate subsidy regime; eligible P&K fertilisers receive NBS. - CORRECT: Correct: India uses different price and subsidy architectures. The option states: Urea has controlled MRP under a separate subsidy regime; eligible P&K fertilisers receive NBS.

D. NBS rates never change by season. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: NBS rates are notified periodically. The option states: NBS rates never change by season.

Method / explanation: India uses different price and subsidy architectures. The option states: Urea has controlled MRP under a separate subsidy regime; eligible P&K fertilisers receive NBS.

Trap: Relative price regimes affect nutrient balance.

Q24. Answer: D | Economy

Which crop-category statement is most accurate?

A. Every food crop is non-commercial. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Food crops can be market-oriented. The option states: Every food crop is non-commercial.

B. All oilseeds fit one exclusive category in every classification. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Classification purpose can place crops differently. The option states: All oilseeds fit one exclusive category in every classification.

C. Tea is a seasonal field cereal. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Tea is a perennial plantation crop. The option states: Tea is a seasonal field cereal.

D. Plantation crops are typically perennial estate crops, while horticulture includes fruits, vegetables, spices and flowers. - CORRECT: Correct: The statement uses production-system and crop-use distinctions correctly. The option states: Plantation crops are typically perennial estate crops, while horticulture includes fruits, vegetables, spices and flowers.

Method / explanation: The statement uses production-system and crop-use distinctions correctly. The option states: Plantation crops are typically perennial estate crops, while horticulture includes fruits, vegetables, spices and flowers.

Trap: Crop categories are analytical and can overlap economically.

Q25. Answer: A | Ancient History

Consider the following statements about Harappan drainage: 1. Household drains, wells and street drains are material evidence for planned built practice. 2. Their presence directly identifies the title of the authority that maintained them. 3. Their layout can support an inference of recurring civic maintenance. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - CORRECT: Correct: Statements 1 and 3 are defensible. Drainage can demonstrate coordinated maintenance, but archaeology does not provide the office or title of a ruler or administrator.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "2 and 3 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that statements 1 and 3 are defensible. Drainage can demonstrate coordinated maintenance, but archaeology does not provide the office or title of a ruler or administrator.

C. 1 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "1 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that statements 1 and 3 are defensible. Drainage can demonstrate coordinated maintenance, but archaeology does not provide the office or title of a ruler or administrator.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "1, 2 and 3" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that statements 1 and 3 are defensible. Drainage can demonstrate coordinated maintenance, but archaeology does not provide the office or title of a ruler or administrator.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 3 are defensible. Drainage can demonstrate coordinated maintenance, but archaeology does not provide the office or title of a ruler or administrator.

Trap: Drainage reveals maintenance needs, not the title of the maintaining authority.

Q26. Answer: B | Ancient History

Which one of the following pairs is correctly matched?

A. Kalibangan - Dancing Girl figurine - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "Kalibangan - Dancing Girl figurine" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that dholavira is the reservoir/signboard/tripartite-plan anchor. Great Bath belongs to Mohenjo-daro, Kalibangan to ploughed field/fire installations, and the giant signboard is Dholavira, not Lothal.

B. Dholavira - reservoirs and a distinctive tripartite plan - CORRECT: Correct: Dholavira is the reservoir/signboard/tripartite-plan anchor. Great Bath belongs to Mohenjo-daro, Kalibangan to ploughed field/fire installations, and the giant signboard is Dholavira, not Lothal.

C. Lothal - giant signboard - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "Lothal - giant signboard" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that dholavira is the reservoir/signboard/tripartite-plan anchor. Great Bath belongs to Mohenjo-daro, Kalibangan to ploughed field/fire installations, and the giant signboard is Dholavira, not Lothal.

D. Harappa - Great Bath - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "Harappa - Great Bath" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that dholavira is the reservoir/signboard/tripartite-plan anchor. Great Bath belongs to Mohenjo-daro, Kalibangan to ploughed field/fire installations, and the giant signboard is Dholavira, not Lothal.

Method / explanation: Dholavira is the reservoir/signboard/tripartite-plan anchor. Great Bath belongs to Mohenjo-daro, Kalibangan to ploughed field/fire installations, and the giant signboard is Dholavira, not Lothal.

Trap: Do not move Dholavira's reservoirs or signboard to another site.

Q27. Answer: C | Ancient History

Which one of the following statements best distinguishes an observation from an inference?

A. 'The script is translated' is observation, whereas a seal is an inference. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "'The script is translated' is observation, whereas a seal is an inference." is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that the image on the seal is observable; the deity identification is interpretive. This distinction is central wherever the unread script limits direct confirmation.

B. 'The Harappans used drainage' is an inference, whereas 'they had an emperor' is observation. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "'The Harappans used drainage' is an inference, whereas 'they had an emperor' is observation." is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that the image on the seal is observable; the deity identification is interpretive. This distinction is central wherever the unread script limits direct confirmation.

C. 'A seal carries a horned figure' is observation; identifying it as Pashupati is an interpretation. - CORRECT: Correct: The image on the seal is observable; the deity identification is interpretive. This distinction is central wherever the unread script limits direct confirmation.

D. 'Mother Goddess' is a material observation, whereas a figurine is speculation. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "'Mother Goddess' is a material observation, whereas a figurine is speculation." is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that the image on the seal is observable; the deity identification is interpretive. This distinction is central wherever the unread script limits direct confirmation.

Method / explanation: The image on the seal is observable; the deity identification is interpretive. This distinction is central wherever the unread script limits direct confirmation.

Trap: Observation is the object or context; Pashupati, palace and empire are interpretations.

Q28. Answer: D | Ancient History

Consider the following statements regarding Late Harappan developments: 1. Urban traits weakened unevenly after c. 1900 BCE. 2. Regional material traditions became more prominent. 3. Agricultural diversification and settlement shifts are relevant to the phase. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "1 and 2 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that all three describe localisation/de-urbanisation as a process. They are why Late Harappan should not be equated with an empty post-collapse interval.

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "2 and 3 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that all three describe localisation/de-urbanisation as a process. They are why Late Harappan should not be equated with an empty post-collapse interval.

C. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the claim "1 and 3 only" is the distractor in this item. The controlling distinction is that all three describe localisation/de-urbanisation as a process. They are why Late Harappan should not be equated with an empty post-collapse interval.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - CORRECT: Correct: All three describe localisation/de-urbanisation as a process. They are why Late Harappan should not be equated with an empty post-collapse interval.

Method / explanation: All three describe localisation/de-urbanisation as a process. They are why Late Harappan should not be equated with an empty post-collapse interval.

Trap: Late Harappan means localisation with continuing communities, not an empty interval.

Q29. Answer: A | Medieval History

With reference to The Tughlaqs: Muhammad bin Tughlaq & Firuz Shah, consider the following statements: 1. Daulatabad: Deogir was renamed Daulatabad and used as a second capital to improve control over south India; officials, leading men and some Sufis were pressured to move, but Delhi was not emptied. 2. Token currency: copper and brass coins were assigned the value of precious-metal currency; the scheme failed because unrestricted private imitation and weak verification destroyed confidence. 3. Token currency failed because paper money was unknown in the world. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Tughlaqs: Muhammad bin Tughlaq & Firuz Shah; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Token currency existed elsewhere; failure in India came from forgery and weak enforcement.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Token currency failed because paper money was unknown in the world.' and replaces it with 'Token currency existed elsewhere; failure in India came from forgery and weak enforcement.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Token currency failed because paper money was unknown in the world.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Token currency existed elsewhere; failure in India came from forgery and weak enforcement.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Token currency existed elsewhere; failure in India came from forgery and weak enforcement.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Token currency failed because paper money was unknown in the world. -> Token currency existed elsewhere; failure in India came from forgery and weak enforcement.

Q30. Answer: B | Medieval History

With reference to Decline of the Sultanate: Timur, Sayyids & Lodis, consider the following statements: 1. Firuz's reforms appeased nobles and soldiers but weakened the central machinery; after his death, nobles, rajas and Firuzi slaves intervened in succession politics. 2. By the late Tughlaq phase, the sultan's real authority had shrunk sharply; the famous joke said the "Lord of the Universe" ruled only from Delhi to Palam. 3. Sayyid rule was either a strong empire or meaningless weakness. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Sayyid rule was either a strong empire or meaningless weakness.' and replaces it with 'It was a limited Delhi-centred polity negotiating tribute, nobles and regional powers.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Decline of the Sultanate: Timur, Sayyids & Lodis; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It was a limited Delhi-centred polity negotiating tribute, nobles and regional powers.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Sayyid rule was either a strong empire or meaningless weakness.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It was a limited Delhi-centred polity negotiating tribute, nobles and regional powers.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It was a limited Delhi-centred polity negotiating tribute, nobles and regional powers.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Sayyid rule was either a strong empire or meaningless weakness. -> It was a limited Delhi-centred polity negotiating tribute, nobles and regional powers.

Q31. Answer: C | Medieval History

With reference to Administration, Economy & Society under the Sultanate, consider the following statements: 1. The sultan held supreme political, military and legal authority, acted as commander-in-chief, and could hear appeals against officials. 2. Succession had no settled rule: all sons had claims, nomination needed noble acceptance, and military strength often decided outcomes. 3. Iqta was identical to later Mughal jagir in every respect. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Iqta was identical to later Mughal jagir in every respect.' and replaces it with 'It was an earlier Sultanate assignment with its own controls and evolution.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Iqta was identical to later Mughal jagir in every respect.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Administration, Economy & Society under the Sultanate; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It was an earlier Sultanate assignment with its own controls and evolution.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It was an earlier Sultanate assignment with its own controls and evolution.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It was an earlier Sultanate assignment with its own controls and evolution.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Iqta was identical to later Mughal jagir in every respect. -> It was an earlier Sultanate assignment with its own controls and evolution.

Q32. Answer: D | Medieval History

With reference to Provincial & Regional Kingdoms (Bengal, Gujarat, Malwa, Jaunpur, Kashmir), consider the following statements: 1. A balance of power emerged: Gujarat, Malwa and Mewar checked one another in the west; Bengal was checked by Orissa and Jaunpur; the Lodis later fought Jaunpur for the Ganga-Yamuna valley. 2. Malwa's plateau position made it a strategic "barrier" between Gujarat, Mewar, the Bahmanis and Delhi. 3. Fanam was a Delhi Sultanate office-term or standard north Indian silver coin. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Fanam was a Delhi Sultanate office-term or standard north Indian silver coin.' and replaces it with 'It was a small gold coin of south Indian/coastal circulation.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Fanam was a Delhi Sultanate office-term or standard north Indian silver coin.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It was a small gold coin of south Indian/coastal circulation.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Provincial & Regional Kingdoms (Bengal, Gujarat, Malwa, Jaunpur, Kashmir); statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It was a small gold coin of south Indian/coastal circulation.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It was a small gold coin of south Indian/coastal circulation.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Fanam was a Delhi Sultanate office-term or standard north Indian silver coin. -> It was a small gold coin of south Indian/coastal circulation.

Q33. Answer: A | Modern History

With reference to Economic Impact of British Rule, consider the following statements: 1. The British conquest tied India to the needs of British capitalism: raw materials, markets for manufactured goods, revenue for administration and profits for investors. 2. Drain of wealth meant a unilateral transfer of Indian resources to Britain without an equivalent economic return. 3. Railways prove colonial rule was economically benevolent. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Economic Impact of British Rule; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Railways served imperial control, exports and British capital, though they had unintended integrating effects.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Railways prove colonial rule was economically benevolent.' and replaces it with 'Railways served imperial control, exports and British capital, though they had unintended integrating effects.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Railways prove colonial rule was economically benevolent.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Railways served imperial control, exports and British capital, though they had unintended integrating effects.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Railways served imperial control, exports and British capital, though they had unintended integrating effects.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Railways prove colonial rule was economically benevolent. -> Railways served imperial control, exports and British capital, though they had unintended integrating effects.

Q34. Answer: B | Modern History

With reference to Administrative Organisation (Civil Service, Army, Police, Judiciary), consider the following statements: 1. The British built a highly centralised administrative machine to maintain order, collect revenue and protect imperial interests. 2. Cornwallis is associated with founding the covenanted civil service, high official salaries and efforts to curb corruption among Company servants. 3. Indians freely entered the civil service after 1853. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Indians freely entered the civil service after 1853.' and replaces it with 'The exam was in London and conditions restricted Indian entry.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Administrative Organisation (Civil Service, Army, Police, Judiciary); statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: The exam was in London and conditions restricted Indian entry.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Indians freely entered the civil service after 1853.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: The exam was in London and conditions restricted Indian entry.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: The exam was in London and conditions restricted Indian entry.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Indians freely entered the civil service after 1853. -> The exam was in London and conditions restricted Indian entry.

Q35. Answer: C | Modern History

With reference to Social & Cultural Policy - Education & the Press, consider the following statements: 1. Early British policy included Orientalist institutions such as Calcutta Madrasa (1781) and Sanskrit College, Banaras (1791). 2. The Charter Act, 1813 provided Rs 1 lakh for education and allowed Christian missionaries to work in India. 3. Sati abolition was only a British humanitarian act. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Sati abolition was only a British humanitarian act.' and replaces it with 'Indian reformers, especially Rammohan Roy, were central to the campaign.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Sati abolition was only a British humanitarian act.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Social & Cultural Policy - Education & the Press; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Indian reformers, especially Rammohan Roy, were central to the campaign.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Indian reformers, especially Rammohan Roy, were central to the campaign.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Indian reformers, especially Rammohan Roy, were central to the campaign.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Sati abolition was only a British humanitarian act. -> Indian reformers, especially Rammohan Roy, were central to the campaign.

Q36. Answer: D | Modern History

With reference to Socio-Religious Reform Movements, consider the following statements: 1. Nineteenth-century reform movements attacked social evils such as sati, child marriage, caste rigidity, purdah, denial of women's education and irrational customs. 2. Raja Rammohan Roy combined monotheism, rationalism and social reform; he founded Atmiya Sabha and later the Brahmo Samaj (1828), opposed sati and idolatry, supported English education, and used Sambad Kaumudi for public opinion. 3. Ramakrishna Mission was founded by Ramakrishna Paramhansa. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Ramakrishna Mission was founded by Ramakrishna Paramhansa.' and replaces it with 'It was founded by Swami Vivekananda in 1897.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Ramakrishna Mission was founded by Ramakrishna Paramhansa.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It was founded by Swami Vivekananda in 1897.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Socio-Religious Reform Movements; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It was founded by Swami Vivekananda in 1897.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It was founded by Swami Vivekananda in 1897.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Ramakrishna Mission was founded by Ramakrishna Paramhansa. -> It was founded by Swami Vivekananda in 1897.

Q37. Answer: A | Modern History

With reference to The Revolt of 1857, consider the following statements: 1. Political causes included the Doctrine of Lapse, annexations, the annexation of Awadh in 1856, and disrespect shown to old Mughal and Peshwa lines. 2. Economic causes included ruin of artisans, pressure on peasants, heavy revenue demands and the wider disruption produced by colonial rule. 3. The cartridge issue was the only cause. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Revolt of 1857; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It was the immediate trigger, not the full cause.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The cartridge issue was the only cause.' and replaces it with 'It was the immediate trigger, not the full cause.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The cartridge issue was the only cause.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It was the immediate trigger, not the full cause.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It was the immediate trigger, not the full cause.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The cartridge issue was the only cause. -> It was the immediate trigger, not the full cause.

Q38. Answer: B | Modern History

With reference to Administrative & Constitutional Changes after 1858, consider the following statements: 1. The Government of India Act 1858 abolished the East India Company's rule and the Board of Control, transferring Indian administration directly to the British Crown. 2. A Secretary of State for India was created in Britain, assisted by a 15-member Council of India. 3. Government of India Act 1858 introduced elected legislatures. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Government of India Act 1858 introduced elected legislatures.' and replaces it with 'It transferred authority to the Crown, not democracy.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Administrative & Constitutional Changes after 1858; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It transferred authority to the Crown, not democracy.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Government of India Act 1858 introduced elected legislatures.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It transferred authority to the Crown, not democracy.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It transferred authority to the Crown, not democracy.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Government of India Act 1858 introduced elected legislatures. -> It transferred authority to the Crown, not democracy.

Q39. Answer: C | Art and Culture

Which statement about Indian glass craft chronology is correct?

A. Glassmaking appears only in Mughal India and has no earlier evidence. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The other options ignore early textual and archaeological evidence or shrink the syllabus to textiles alone. The option tested was 'Glassmaking appears only in Mughal India and has no earlier evidence.'

B. The first evidence for glass is the GI Registry in Chennai. - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Topic 12 explicitly includes glassware and its chronology. The option tested was 'The first evidence for glass is the GI Registry in Chennai.'

C. Nitin records a long chain from epic and Vedic references to Painted Grey Ware evidence and the Brahmapuri-Kolhapur industry. - **CORRECT:** Correct: The other options ignore early textual and archaeological evidence or shrink the syllabus to textiles alone. The option tested was 'Nitin records a long chain from epic and Vedic references to Painted Grey Ware evidence and the Brahmapuri-Kolhapur industry.'

D. Indian glass history is outside Topic 12 because it is not a textile. - **INCORRECT:** Incorrect: Topic 12 explicitly includes glassware and its chronology. The option tested was 'Indian glass history is outside Topic 12 because it is not a textile.'

Method / explanation: The other options ignore early textual and archaeological evidence or shrink the syllabus to textiles alone. The option tested was 'Nitin records a long chain from epic and Vedic references to Painted Grey Ware evidence and the Brahmapuri-Kolhapur industry.'

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q40. Answer: D | Art and Culture

Which statement best captures Article 49?

A. It creates a citizen's Fundamental Duty to preserve heritage. - **INCORRECT:** Incorrect: Article 49 is a State obligation with a specific protective verb list. The remaining options misstate the category, mandate, chronology or concept in question. The option tested was 'It creates a citizen's Fundamental Duty to preserve heritage.'

B. It is a state list entry for tourism promotion. - **INCORRECT:** Incorrect: Article 49 is a State obligation with a specific protective verb list. The option tested was 'It is a state list entry for tourism promotion.'

C. It is the article creating the World Heritage Committee. - **INCORRECT:** Incorrect: Article 49 is a State obligation with a specific protective verb list. The option tested was 'It is the article creating the World Heritage Committee.'

D. It places on the State an obligation to protect monuments and objects of national importance from harm including removal, disposal and export. - **CORRECT:** Correct: Article 49 is a State obligation with a specific protective verb list. The option tested was 'It places on the State an obligation to protect monuments and objects of national importance from harm including removal, disposal and export.'

Method / explanation: Article 49 is a State obligation with a specific protective verb list. The option tested was 'It places on the State an obligation to protect monuments and objects of national importance from harm including removal, disposal and export.'

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q41. Answer: A | Art and Culture

Which statement best explains the Buddhist stupa in Topic 13?

A. It is a relic-centred circumambulatory form and should not be reduced to a normal entry hall. - **CORRECT:** Correct: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'It is a relic-centred circumambulatory form and should not be reduced to a normal entry hall.'

B. It proves Buddhism invented commemorative mound architecture out of nothing. - **INCORRECT:** Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'It proves Buddhism invented commemorative mound architecture out of nothing.'

C. It was designed only for royal residence. - **INCORRECT:** Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'It was designed only for royal residence.'

D. It is merely a later Shaiva shrine in rounded form. - **INCORRECT:** Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'It is merely a later Shaiva shrine in rounded form.'

Method / explanation: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'It is a relic-centred circumambulatory form and should not be reduced to a normal entry hall.'

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q42. Answer: B | Art and Culture

Which pair is correctly matched in the Sangam bank?

A. Agam - outer public field of war and statecraft only - **INCORRECT:** Incorrect: Agam is the inner field, Pattuppattu belongs to the Ten Idylls corpus, and Vatakkiruttal is a Sangam-age ritual practice rather than a Buddhist commentary. The option tested was 'Agam - outer public field of war and statecraft only'.

B. Tolkappiyam - Tamil grammar and cultural classification text - **CORRECT:** Correct: Agam is the inner field, Pattuppattu belongs to the Ten Idylls corpus, and Vatakkiruttal is a Sangam-age ritual practice rather than a Buddhist commentary. The option tested was 'Tolkappiyam - Tamil grammar and cultural classification text'.

C. Pattuppattu - Perso-Arabic calligraphic style - **INCORRECT:** Incorrect: Agam is the inner field, Pattuppattu belongs to the Ten Idylls corpus, and Vatakkiruttal is a Sangam-age ritual practice rather than a Buddhist commentary. The option tested was

'Pattuppattu - Perso-Arabic calligraphic style'.

D. Vatakkiruttal - Buddhist commentary on Vinaya rules - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Agam is the inner field, Pattuppattu belongs to the Ten Idylls corpus, and Vatakkiruttal is a Sangam-age ritual practice rather than a Buddhist commentary. The option tested was 'Vatakkiruttal - Buddhist commentary on Vinaya rules'.

Method / explanation: Agam is the inner field, Pattuppattu belongs to the Ten Idylls corpus, and Vatakkiruttal is a Sangam-age ritual practice rather than a Buddhist commentary. The option tested was 'Tolkappiyam - Tamil grammar and cultural classification text'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q43. Answer: C | Art and Culture

Which pair is correctly matched?

A. Khajuraho - boundary-wall-dominated walled enclosure as its main external identity - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Khajuraho is instead known for high jagati terraces without enclosure walls, Konark is richly carved, and Modhera belongs to the Nagara-Solanki world rather than a gopuram-centred granite formula. The option tested was 'Khajuraho - boundary-wall-dominated walled enclosure as its main external identity'.

B. Konark - no external sculptural programme and plain walls - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Khajuraho is instead known for high jagati terraces without enclosure walls, Konark is richly carved, and Modhera belongs to the Nagara-Solanki world rather than a gopuram-centred granite formula. The option tested was 'Konark - no external sculptural programme and plain walls'.

C. Odisha/Kalinga - rekha deul sanctum with pidha deul hall as a recurring regional combination - CORRECT: Correct: for the Odisha/Kalinga school. The option tested was 'Odisha/Kalinga - rekha deul sanctum with pidha deul hall as a recurring regional combination'.

D. Modhera - free-standing granite gopuram as the core identifier - INCORRECT: Incorrect: Khajuraho is instead known for high jagati terraces without enclosure walls, Konark is richly carved, and Modhera belongs to the Nagara-Solanki world rather than a gopuram-centred granite formula. The option tested was 'Modhera - free-standing granite gopuram as the core identifier'.

Method / explanation: for the Odisha/Kalinga school. The option tested was 'Odisha/Kalinga - rekha deul sanctum with pidha deul hall as a recurring regional combination'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q44. Answer: D | Art and Culture

Which institutional pair is correctly matched?

A. Sangeet Natak Akademi - founded in 1901 by Paluskar - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'Sangeet Natak Akademi - founded in 1901 by Paluskar'.

B. SPIC MACAY - first codifier of melakarta - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'SPIC MACAY - first codifier of melakarta'.

C. Prayag Sangeet Samiti - founded by Akbar - INCORRECT: Incorrect: The source does not support this identification. The option tested was 'Prayag Sangeet Samiti - founded by Akbar'.

D. Sangeet Natak Akademi - 1952; SPIC MACAY - 1977 - CORRECT: Correct: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'Sangeet Natak Akademi - 1952; SPIC MACAY - 1977'.

Method / explanation: The source supports this exact identification. The option tested was 'Sangeet Natak Akademi - 1952; SPIC MACAY - 1977'.

Trap: Reject attractive options that change the institution, chronology, scale or legal status tested by the stem.

Q45. Answer: A | Geography

With reference to Weather: Insolation, Pressure, Winds, Humidity & Rainfall, consider the following statements: 1. Doldrums = equatorial low, calm ascending air and convectional rainfall. 2. Horse Latitudes = sub-tropical high pressure near 30 deg, descending dry air and major deserts (Sahara, Thar, Kalahari). 3. A heat dome is a type of cyclone. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Weather: Insolation, Pressure, Winds, Humidity & Rainfall; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It is an anticyclone (high pressure) with descending air - the opposite of a cyclone's ascending low-pressure air.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A heat dome is a type of cyclone.' and replaces it with 'It is an anticyclone (high pressure) with descending air - the opposite of a cyclone's ascending low-pressure air.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A heat dome is a type of cyclone.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It is an anticyclone (high pressure) with descending air - the opposite of a cyclone's ascending low-pressure air.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It is an anticyclone (high pressure) with descending air - the opposite of a cyclone's ascending low-pressure air.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A heat dome is a type of cyclone. -> It is an anticyclone (high pressure) with descending air - the opposite of a cyclone's ascending low-pressure air.

Q46. Answer: B | Geography

With reference to Climate Classification: The Koppen System, consider the following statements: 1. Koppen is empirical/data-based, not genetic/cause-based. 2. Group A: coolest month above 18C. 3. Only rainfall decline can expand a desert (BWh). Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Only rainfall decline can expand a desert (BWh).' and replaces it with 'Because B is aridity-defined (evaporation vs rain), rising temperature increases evaporation and can expand the arid zone even with stable rainfall.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Climate Classification: The Koppen System; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Because B is aridity-defined (evaporation vs rain), rising temperature increases evaporation and can expand the arid zone even with stable rainfall.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Only rainfall decline can expand a desert (BWh).

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Because B is aridity-defined (evaporation vs rain), rising temperature increases evaporation and can expand the arid zone even with stable rainfall.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Because B is aridity-defined (evaporation vs rain), rising temperature increases evaporation and can expand the arid zone even with stable rainfall.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Only rainfall decline can expand a desert (BWh). -> Because B is aridity-defined (evaporation vs rain), rising temperature increases evaporation and can expand the arid zone even with stable rainfall.

Q47. Answer: C | Geography

With reference to The Hot, Wet Equatorial Climate, consider the following statements: 1. Koppen Af; located about 5-10 N/S of the Equator. 2. Greatest extent: Amazon, Congo, Malaysia, East Indies. 3. Equatorial climate has a large annual temperature range due to heavy rain. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Equatorial climate has a large annual temperature range due to heavy rain.' and replaces it with 'Annual range is tiny (<3C); diurnal range is larger.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Equatorial climate has a large annual temperature range due to heavy rain.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Hot, Wet Equatorial Climate; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Annual range is tiny (<3C); diurnal range is larger.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Annual range is tiny (<3C); diurnal range is larger.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Annual range is tiny (<3C); diurnal range is larger.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Equatorial climate has a large annual temperature range due to heavy rain. -> Annual range is tiny (<3C); diurnal range is larger.

Q48. Answer: D | Geography

With reference to Tropical Monsoon and Tropical Marine Climate, consider the following statements: 1. Koppen Am; tropical monsoon located about 10-30 N/S on eastern/southern margins. 2. Defining feature = complete seasonal reversal of wind direction. 3. Tamil Nadu gets most rain from the SW monsoon. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Tamil Nadu gets most rain from the SW monsoon.' and replaces it with 'Coastal Tamil Nadu receives its main rain from the retreating/NE monsoon.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Tamil Nadu gets most rain from the SW monsoon.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Coastal Tamil Nadu receives its main rain from the retreating/NE monsoon.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Tropical Monsoon and Tropical Marine Climate; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Coastal Tamil Nadu receives its main rain from the retreating/NE monsoon.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Coastal Tamil Nadu receives its main rain from the retreating/NE monsoon.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Tamil Nadu gets most rain from the SW monsoon. -> Coastal Tamil Nadu receives its main rain from the retreating/NE monsoon.

Q49. Answer: A | Geography

With reference to Savanna / Sudan Climate, consider the following statements: 1. Koppen Aw; transitional between equatorial forest and hot desert. 2. Best developed in the Sudan belt of Africa. 3. Savanna is purely natural climax vegetation untouched by humans. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Savanna / Sudan Climate; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Human-set annual fires strongly shape and maintain savanna grassland.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Savanna is purely natural climax vegetation untouched by humans.' and replaces it with 'Human-set annual fires strongly shape and maintain savanna grassland.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Savanna is purely natural climax vegetation untouched by humans.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Human-set annual fires strongly shape and maintain savanna grassland.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Human-set annual fires strongly shape and maintain savanna grassland.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Savanna is purely natural climax vegetation untouched by humans. -> Human-set annual fires strongly shape and maintain savanna grassland.

Q50. Answer: B | Geography

With reference to Hot and Mid-Latitude Desert Climate, consider the following statements: 1. Deserts = regions of scanty rainfall; aridity is the keynote. 2. Hot deserts are Trade-Wind deserts. 3. All deserts form only because of lack of vegetation. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'All deserts form only because of lack of vegetation.' and replaces it with 'Aridity arises from wind belts, subsidence, cold currents, continentality and rain shadow.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Hot and Mid-Latitude Desert Climate; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Aridity arises from wind belts, subsidence, cold currents, continentality and rain shadow.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: All deserts form only because of lack of vegetation.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Aridity arises from wind belts, subsidence, cold currents, continentality and rain shadow.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Aridity arises from wind belts, subsidence, cold currents, continentality and rain shadow.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: All deserts form only because of lack of vegetation. -> Aridity arises from wind belts, subsidence, cold currents, continentality and rain shadow.

Q51. Answer: C | Geography

With reference to Mediterranean Climate, consider the following statements: 1. Koppen Cs; western margins, 30-45 N/S. 2. Dry sunny summer + wet mild winter. 3. Sirocco and Mistral are both hot winds. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Sirocco and Mistral are both hot winds.' and replaces it with 'Sirocco is hot and dusty; Mistral is cold and stormy.'
- B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Sirocco and Mistral are both hot winds.
- C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Mediterranean Climate; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Sirocco is hot and dusty; Mistral is cold and stormy.
- D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Sirocco is hot and dusty; Mistral is cold and stormy.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Sirocco is hot and dusty; Mistral is cold and stormy.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Sirocco and Mistral are both hot winds. -> Sirocco is hot and dusty; Mistral is cold and stormy.

Q52. Answer: D | Geography

With reference to Temperate Continental Steppe Climate, consider the following statements: 1. Local names: Steppes, Prairies, Pampas, Veld, Downs. 2. Found in mid-latitude continental interiors, bordering deserts. 3. Temperate grasslands are treeless because of poor soil. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Temperate grasslands are treeless because of poor soil.' and replaces it with 'Soils are often very fertile; treelessness is due to low rainfall and remoteness from maritime moisture.'
- B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Temperate grasslands are treeless because of poor soil.
- C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Soils are often very fertile; treelessness is due to low rainfall and remoteness from maritime moisture.
- D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Temperate Continental Steppe Climate; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Soils are often very fertile; treelessness is due to low rainfall and remoteness from maritime moisture.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Soils are often very fertile; treelessness is due to low rainfall and remoteness from maritime moisture.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Temperate grasslands are treeless because of poor soil. -> Soils are often very fertile; treelessness is due to low rainfall and remoteness from maritime moisture.

Q53. Answer: A | Geography

With reference to The Warm Temperate Eastern Margin (China Type) Climate, consider the following statements: 1. China type = temperate monsoon climate on warm-temperate eastern margins; summer max rain. 2. Three sub-types: China (temperate monsoonal), Gulf (slight-monsoonal), Natal (non-monsoonal). 3. Typhoons form near the coast. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Warm Temperate Eastern Margin (China Type) Climate; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: they originate in the Pacific and move westward.
- B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Typhoons form near the coast.' and replaces it with 'they originate in the Pacific and move westward.'
- C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Typhoons form near the coast.
- D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: they originate in the Pacific and move westward.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: they originate in the Pacific and move westward.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Typhoons form near the coast. -> they originate in the Pacific and move westward.

Q54. Answer: B | Geography

With reference to The Cool Temperate Western Margin (British Type) Climate, consider the following statements: 1. British type = cool temperate western margin, 45-65N/S, ruled by Westerlies + cyclones. 2. Also called North-West European

Maritime climate. 3. British type has a summer rainfall maximum. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'British type has a summer rainfall maximum.' and replaces it with 'rain is year-round, max in autumn/winter.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Cool Temperate Western Margin (British Type) Climate; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: rain is year-round, max in autumn/winter.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: British type has a summer rainfall maximum.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: rain is year-round, max in autumn/winter.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: rain is year-round, max in autumn/winter.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: British type has a summer rainfall maximum. -> rain is year-round, max in autumn/winter.

Q55. Answer: C | Geography

With reference to The Cool Temperate Continental (Siberian) Climate, consider the following statements: 1. Siberian type occurs only in the Northern Hemisphere (broad continents; no S-hemisphere land). 2. Poleward -> tundra; equatorward -> Steppe. 3. It has a summer-dry, winter-rain regime. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'It has a summer-dry, winter-rain regime.' and replaces it with 'low rainfall, light summer maximum.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: It has a summer-dry, winter-rain regime.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Cool Temperate Continental (Siberian) Climate; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: low rainfall, light summer maximum.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: low rainfall, light summer maximum.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: low rainfall, light summer maximum.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: It has a summer-dry, winter-rain regime. -> low rainfall, light summer maximum.

Q56. Answer: D | Geography

With reference to The Cool Temperate Eastern Margin (Laurentian) Climate, consider the following statements: 1. Laurentian = intermediate between British (maritime) and Siberian (continental) types. 2. Occurs in only two regions: NE North America and East Asia; absent in S. Hemisphere. 3. Grand Banks fisheries arise simply because two currents meet. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Grand Banks fisheries arise simply because two currents meet.' and replaces it with 'shallow shelf, mixing, nutrients, water masses and fisheries management all matter.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Grand Banks fisheries arise simply because two currents meet.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: shallow shelf, mixing, nutrients, water masses and fisheries management all matter.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about The Cool Temperate Eastern Margin (Laurentian) Climate; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: shallow shelf, mixing, nutrients, water masses and fisheries management all matter.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: shallow shelf, mixing, nutrients, water masses and fisheries management all matter.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Grand Banks fisheries arise simply because two currents meet. -> shallow shelf, mixing, nutrients, water masses and fisheries management all matter.

Q57. Answer: A | Environment

With reference to Air Pollution and CPCB Standards, consider the following statements: 1. CPCB is the apex statutory body setting National Ambient Air Quality Standards (NAAQS) under the Air Act, 1981. 2. PM_{2.5} (fine particulate matter) is considered more health-hazardous than PM₁₀ because of its ability to penetrate deeper into the respiratory system. 3. The Air Act, 1981 was enacted under the Concurrent List entry on public health. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Air Pollution and CPCB Standards; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It was enacted under Article 253 to implement decisions of the 1972 Stockholm Conference.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Air Act, 1981 was enacted under the Concurrent List entry on public health.' and replaces it with 'It was enacted under Article 253 to implement decisions of the 1972 Stockholm Conference.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Air Act, 1981 was enacted under the Concurrent List entry on public health.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It was enacted under Article 253 to implement decisions of the 1972 Stockholm Conference.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It was enacted under Article 253 to implement decisions of the 1972 Stockholm Conference.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Air Act, 1981 was enacted under the Concurrent List entry on public health. -> It was enacted under Article 253 to implement decisions of the 1972 Stockholm Conference.

Q58. Answer: B | Environment

With reference to Water Pollution and River Cleaning Missions, consider the following statements: 1. The Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974 established CPCB and SPCBs as the regulatory bodies for water-pollution control in India. 2. High BOD combined with low Dissolved Oxygen and high faecal coliform count is the classic signature of sewage/organic pollution. 3. The National Ganga Council is chaired by the Union Jal Shakti Minister. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The National Ganga Council is chaired by the Union Jal Shakti Minister.' and replaces it with 'It is chaired by the Prime Minister; the Empowered Task Force is chaired by the Jal Shakti Minister.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Water Pollution and River Cleaning Missions; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It is chaired by the Prime Minister; the Empowered Task Force is chaired by the Jal Shakti Minister.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The National Ganga Council is chaired by the Union Jal Shakti Minister.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It is chaired by the Prime Minister; the Empowered Task Force is chaired by the Jal Shakti Minister.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It is chaired by the Prime Minister; the Empowered Task Force is chaired by the Jal Shakti Minister.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The National Ganga Council is chaired by the Union Jal Shakti Minister. -> It is chaired by the Prime Minister; the Empowered Task Force is chaired by the Jal Shakti Minister.

Q59. Answer: C | Environment

With reference to Solid Plastic and E-Waste Rules, consider the following statements: 1. India regulates municipal solid waste, plastic waste and e-waste through three separate rule frameworks, all notified under the Environment (Protection) Act, 1986. 2. Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) is the common accountability mechanism across the plastic and e-waste rule frameworks, making producers responsible for end-of-life product management. 3. Informal waste-pickers/recyclers play no significant role in India's actual waste economy. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Informal waste-pickers/recyclers play no significant role in India's actual waste economy.' and replaces it with 'They play a substantial, often under-integrated role, especially in plastic and e-waste collection and recycling.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Informal waste-pickers/recyclers play no significant role in India's actual waste economy.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Solid Plastic and E-Waste Rules; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: They play a substantial, often under-integrated role, especially in plastic and e-waste collection and recycling.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: They play a substantial, often under-integrated role, especially in plastic and e-waste collection and recycling.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: They play a substantial, often under-integrated role, especially in plastic and e-waste collection and recycling.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Informal waste-pickers/recyclers play no significant role in India's actual waste economy. -> They play a substantial, often under-integrated role, especially in plastic and e-waste collection and recycling.

Q60. Answer: D | Environment

With reference to Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT, consider the following statements: 1. The EIA Notification, 2006 classifies projects into Category A (central clearance) and Category B (state clearance, further divided into B1 and B2). 2. The EIA process has four stages: screening, scoping, public consultation and appraisal. 3. The Precautionary Principle requires full scientific certainty before any preventive action can be taken. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Precautionary Principle requires full scientific certainty before any preventive action can be taken.' and replaces it with 'It specifically allows preventive action even in the absence of full scientific certainty of harm.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Precautionary Principle requires full scientific certainty before any preventive action can be taken.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It specifically allows preventive action even in the absence of full scientific certainty of harm.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Environmental Impact Assessment and NGT; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It specifically allows preventive action even in the absence of full scientific certainty of harm.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It specifically allows preventive action even in the absence of full scientific certainty of harm.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Precautionary Principle requires full scientific certainty before any preventive action can be taken. -> It specifically allows preventive action even in the absence of full scientific certainty of harm.

Q61. Answer: A | Environment

With reference to Climate Change Science Greenhouse Effect, consider the following statements: 1. The natural greenhouse effect keeps Earth's surface substantially warmer than it would otherwise be, and is essential for life; the current climate-change concern is about its human-driven enhancement. 2. Water vapour, carbon dioxide, methane, nitrous oxide and fluorinated gases are the principal greenhouse gases; water vapour is the most abundant but is not the primary target of climate-mitigation policy since its atmospheric levels respond to temperature rather than being a direct driver of new forcing. 3. Any specific extreme-weather event can be directly and simply attributed to climate change without further study. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Climate Change Science Greenhouse Effect; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Precise event attribution requires dedicated attribution-science analysis; general climate trends and single events are distinct claims.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Any specific extreme-weather event can be directly and simply attributed to climate change without further study.' and replaces it with 'Precise event attribution requires dedicated attribution-science analysis; general climate trends and single events are distinct claims.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Any specific extreme-weather event can be directly and simply attributed to climate change without further study.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Precise event attribution requires dedicated attribution-science analysis; general climate trends and single events are distinct claims.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Precise event attribution requires dedicated attribution-science analysis; general climate trends and single events are distinct claims.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Any specific extreme-weather event can be directly and simply attributed to climate change without further study. -> Precise event attribution

requires dedicated attribution-science analysis; general climate trends and single events are distinct claims.

Q62. Answer: B | Environment

With reference to IPCC Assessment Reports, consider the following statements: 1. The IPCC was established in 1988 by the WMO and UNEP. 2. The IPCC has three Working Groups: I (Physical Science Basis), II (Impacts, Adaptation and Vulnerability), III (Mitigation of Climate Change). 3. The IPCC conducts its own climate experiments and data collection like a research laboratory. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The IPCC conducts its own climate experiments and data collection like a research laboratory.' and replaces it with 'It assesses and synthesises existing published literature; it does not conduct primary research itself.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about IPCC Assessment Reports; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It assesses and synthesises existing published literature; it does not conduct primary research itself.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The IPCC conducts its own climate experiments and data collection like a research laboratory.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It assesses and synthesises existing published literature; it does not conduct primary research itself.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It assesses and synthesises existing published literature; it does not conduct primary research itself.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The IPCC conducts its own climate experiments and data collection like a research laboratory. -> It assesses and synthesises existing published literature; it does not conduct primary research itself.

Q63. Answer: C | Environment

With reference to UNFCCC COP Kyoto Paris Agreement, consider the following statements: 1. The UNFCCC (1992) is the parent framework treaty; it set no binding emission-reduction targets itself. 2. The Kyoto Protocol (1997) set binding targets only for developed (Annex I) countries. 3. The Paris Agreement sets a single binding global emission-reduction target that all countries must legally meet in a specific number. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Paris Agreement sets a single binding global emission-reduction target that all countries must legally meet in a specific number.' and replaces it with 'It sets a binding process obligation (submit/implement/report/ratchet NDCs); the specific numeric NDC targets themselves are nationally self-determined, not internationally imposed.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Paris Agreement sets a single binding global emission-reduction target that all countries must legally meet in a specific number.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about UNFCCC COP Kyoto Paris Agreement; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It sets a binding process obligation (submit/implement/report/ratchet NDCs); the specific numeric NDC targets themselves are nationally self-determined, not internationally imposed.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It sets a binding process obligation (submit/implement/report/ratchet NDCs); the specific numeric NDC targets themselves are nationally self-determined, not internationally imposed.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It sets a binding process obligation (submit/implement/report/ratchet NDCs); the specific numeric NDC targets themselves are nationally self-determined, not internationally imposed.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Paris Agreement sets a single binding global emission-reduction target that all countries must legally meet in a specific number. -> It sets a binding process obligation (submit/implement/report/ratchet NDCs); the specific numeric NDC targets themselves are nationally self-determined, not internationally imposed.

Q64. Answer: D | Environment

With reference to India Climate Policy NAPCC Panchamrit LTLEDS, consider the following statements: 1. NAPCC (2008) launched with eight National Missions: Solar, Enhanced Energy Efficiency, Sustainable Habitat, Water, Sustaining the Himalayan Ecosystem, Green India, Sustainable Agriculture, and Strategic Knowledge for Climate Change. 2. India's Panchamrit (COP26, 2021) includes five pledges: 500 GW non-fossil capacity by 2030; 50% renewable energy share by 2030; one billion tonnes emissions reduction by 2030; 45% reduction in carbon intensity by 2030 (from 2005 levels);

net-zero by 2070. 3. The Panchamrit's "50% renewable energy" target refers to installed capacity share. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The Panchamrit's "50% renewable energy" target refers to installed capacity share.' and replaces it with 'It specifically refers to meeting 50% of energy requirements from renewable sources by 2030, distinct from the separate 500 GW non-fossil installed-capacity target.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The Panchamrit's "50% renewable energy" target refers to installed capacity share.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It specifically refers to meeting 50% of energy requirements from renewable sources by 2030, distinct from the separate 500 GW non-fossil installed-capacity target.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about India Climate Policy NAPCC Panchamrit LTLEDs; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It specifically refers to meeting 50% of energy requirements from renewable sources by 2030, distinct from the separate 500 GW non-fossil installed-capacity target.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It specifically refers to meeting 50% of energy requirements from renewable sources by 2030, distinct from the separate 500 GW non-fossil installed-capacity target.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The Panchamrit's "50% renewable energy" target refers to installed capacity share. -> It specifically refers to meeting 50% of energy requirements from renewable sources by 2030, distinct from the separate 500 GW non-fossil installed-capacity target.

Q65. Answer: A | Environment

With reference to Carbon Markets CCUS and Direct Air Capture, consider the following statements: 1. The Energy Conservation (Amendment) Act, 2022 provides the legal basis for the Indian Carbon Market. 2. CCUS captures CO₂ at concentrated point sources (e.g., power plants, industrial facilities); Direct Air Capture removes CO₂ directly from ambient (dilute) air. 3. A carbon credit certificate and a green credit are the same instrument. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Carbon Markets CCUS and Direct Air Capture; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: CCCs are denominated in tCO₂e under the CCTS; green credits (Green Credit Rules, 2023) reward specified environmental actions and are not emission-denominated.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A carbon credit certificate and a green credit are the same instrument.' and replaces it with 'CCCs are denominated in tCO₂e under the CCTS; green credits (Green Credit Rules, 2023) reward specified environmental actions and are not emission-denominated.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A carbon credit certificate and a green credit are the same instrument.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: CCCs are denominated in tCO₂e under the CCTS; green credits (Green Credit Rules, 2023) reward specified environmental actions and are not emission-denominated.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: CCCs are denominated in tCO₂e under the CCTS; green credits (Green Credit Rules, 2023) reward specified environmental actions and are not emission-denominated.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A carbon credit certificate and a green credit are the same instrument. -> CCCs are denominated in tCO₂e under the CCTS; green credits (Green Credit Rules, 2023) reward specified environmental actions and are not emission-denominated.

Q66. Answer: B | Environment

With reference to Multilateral Environmental Conventions CBD Basel Stockholm Montreal, consider the following statements: 1. The CBD has three specific objectives: conservation, sustainable use, and benefit-sharing - not conservation alone. 2. The Basel Convention specifically addresses transboundary hazardous-waste movement, based on the prior-informed-consent principle. 3. HFCs are ozone-depleting substances regulated for that reason under the Kigali Amendment. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'HFCs are ozone-depleting substances regulated for that reason under the Kigali Amendment.' and replaces it with 'HFCs are not ozone-depleting; they are potent greenhouse gases regulated under the Montreal Protocol's proven institutional architecture specifically because of their climate (not ozone) impact.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Multilateral Environmental Conventions CBD Basel Stockholm Montreal; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: HFCs are not ozone-depleting; they are potent greenhouse gases regulated under the Montreal Protocol's proven institutional architecture

specifically because of their climate (not ozone) impact.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: HFCs are ozone-depleting substances regulated for that reason under the Kigali Amendment.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: HFCs are not ozone-depleting; they are potent greenhouse gases regulated under the Montreal Protocol's proven institutional architecture specifically because of their climate (not ozone) impact.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: HFCs are not ozone-depleting; they are potent greenhouse gases regulated under the Montreal Protocol's proven institutional architecture specifically because of their climate (not ozone) impact.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: HFCs are ozone-depleting substances regulated for that reason under the Kigali Amendment. -> HFCs are not ozone-depleting; they are potent greenhouse gases regulated under the Montreal Protocol's proven institutional architecture specifically because of their climate (not ozone) impact.

Q67. Answer: C | Environment

With reference to Desertification UNCCD and Land Degradation, consider the following statements: 1. Desertification refers specifically to land degradation in drylands (arid, semi-arid, dry sub-humid areas); land degradation is the broader, more general term. 2. Drought is a temporary climatic phenomenon, distinct from desertification, which is a longer-term degradation process. 3. Desertification means the physical spread/advance of existing deserts into new territory. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Desertification means the physical spread/advance of existing deserts into new territory.' and replaces it with 'It refers to land-degradation processes occurring within existing drylands, not literal geographic expansion of sand-desert landscapes.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Desertification means the physical spread/advance of existing deserts into new territory.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Desertification UNCCD and Land Degradation; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It refers to land-degradation processes occurring within existing drylands, not literal geographic expansion of sand-desert landscapes.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It refers to land-degradation processes occurring within existing drylands, not literal geographic expansion of sand-desert landscapes.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It refers to land-degradation processes occurring within existing drylands, not literal geographic expansion of sand-desert landscapes.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Desertification means the physical spread/advance of existing deserts into new territory. -> It refers to land-degradation processes occurring within existing drylands, not literal geographic expansion of sand-desert landscapes.

Q68. Answer: D | Environment

With reference to Coastal and Marine Ecology CRZ Blue Economy, consider the following statements: 1. The CRZ Notification, 2019 classifies India's coastline into four zones: CRZ-I (ecologically sensitive/inter-tidal), CRZ-II (urban), CRZ-III (rural, with a No Development Zone), and CRZ-IV (territorial waters/tidal water bodies). 2. The 2019 Notification reduced the No Development Zone distance for CRZ-III areas compared to the 2011 Notification, reflecting a development-facilitation policy shift. 3. Blue Economy refers to unrestricted extraction of ocean resources for maximum economic gain. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Blue Economy refers to unrestricted extraction of ocean resources for maximum economic gain.' and replaces it with 'It specifically refers to sustainable use of ocean resources balancing economic growth with ecosystem health.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Blue Economy refers to unrestricted extraction of ocean resources for maximum economic gain.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: It specifically refers to sustainable use of ocean resources balancing economic growth with ecosystem health.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Coastal and Marine Ecology CRZ Blue Economy; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: It specifically refers to sustainable use of ocean resources balancing economic growth with ecosystem health.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: It specifically refers to sustainable use of ocean resources balancing economic growth with ecosystem health.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Blue Economy refers to unrestricted extraction of ocean resources for maximum economic gain. -> It specifically refers to sustainable use of ocean resources balancing economic growth with ecosystem health.

Q69. Answer: A | Science and Technology

With reference to Semiconductor Mission and Electronics Manufacturing, consider the following statements: 1. Design, fabrication, and ATMP/OSAT are three separate stages; UPSC should not collapse them into one. 2. ISM functions under MeitY. 3. An approved semiconductor project automatically implies a verified advanced node size. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Semiconductor Mission and Electronics Manufacturing; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: State only what official sources confirm; do not invent node sizes.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'An approved semiconductor project automatically implies a verified advanced node size.' and replaces it with 'State only what official sources confirm; do not invent node sizes.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: An approved semiconductor project automatically implies a verified advanced node size.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: State only what official sources confirm; do not invent node sizes.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: State only what official sources confirm; do not invent node sizes.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: An approved semiconductor project automatically implies a verified advanced node size. -> State only what official sources confirm; do not invent node sizes.

Q70. Answer: B | Science and Technology

With reference to Data Protection, DPDP Act and Cybersecurity, consider the following statements: 1. The DPDP Act is about digital personal data protection, not about overall cyber warfare or network defence. 2. A Consent Manager must be registered with the Board. 3. CERT-In works under the Ministry of Home Affairs. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'CERT-In works under the Ministry of Home Affairs.' and replaces it with 'CERT-In is under MeitY. The MHA body is I4C, which handles cybercrime reporting and coordination.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Data Protection, DPDP Act and Cybersecurity; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: CERT-In is under MeitY. The MHA body is I4C, which handles cybercrime reporting and coordination.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: CERT-In works under the Ministry of Home Affairs.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: CERT-In is under MeitY. The MHA body is I4C, which handles cybercrime reporting and coordination.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: CERT-In is under MeitY. The MHA body is I4C, which handles cybercrime reporting and coordination.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: CERT-In works under the Ministry of Home Affairs. -> CERT-In is under MeitY. The MHA body is I4C, which handles cybercrime reporting and coordination.

Q71. Answer: C | Science and Technology

With reference to Biotechnology Fundamentals and DBT Missions, consider the following statements: 1. DBT is the central department for biotechnology within the Ministry of Science and Technology. 2. BIRAC is a public sector enterprise set up by DBT, not a biosafety regulator. 3. DBT, ICMR, ICAR, CSIR and CDSCO are interchangeable. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'DBT, ICMR, ICAR, CSIR and CDSCO are interchangeable.' and replaces it with 'Four are research/funding bodies in different domains; CDSCO is the statutory approval regulator for drugs and vaccines, and GEAC the regulator for environmental release of GMOs.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: DBT, ICMR, ICAR, CSIR and CDSCO are interchangeable.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Biotechnology Fundamentals and DBT Missions; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Four are research/funding bodies in different domains; CDSCO is the statutory approval regulator for drugs and vaccines, and GEAC the regulator for environmental release of GMOs.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Four are research/funding bodies in different domains; CDSCO is the statutory approval regulator for drugs and vaccines, and GEAC the regulator for environmental release of GMOs.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Four are research/funding bodies in different domains; CDSCO is the statutory approval regulator for drugs and vaccines, and GEAC the regulator for environmental release of GMOs.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: DBT, ICMR, ICAR, CSIR and CDSCO are interchangeable. -> Four are research/funding bodies in different domains; CDSCO is the statutory approval regulator for drugs and vaccines, and GEAC the regulator for environmental release of GMOs.

Q72. Answer: D | Science and Technology

With reference to Genetic Engineering, GM Crops and CRISPR, consider the following statements: 1. GEAC functions in the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, not in DBT. 2. GEAC appraises environmental release of genetically engineered organisms and products, including experimental field-trial proposals. 3. Bt cotton and GM mustard have identical legal status in India. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Bt cotton and GM mustard have identical legal status in India.' and replaces it with 'Bt cotton is commercially cultivated; GM mustard's official materials reviewed here refer to environmental release for seed production/testing under conditions before commercial release.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Bt cotton and GM mustard have identical legal status in India.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Bt cotton is commercially cultivated; GM mustard's official materials reviewed here refer to environmental release for seed production/testing under conditions before commercial release.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Genetic Engineering, GM Crops and CRISPR; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Bt cotton is commercially cultivated; GM mustard's official materials reviewed here refer to environmental release for seed production/testing under conditions before commercial release.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Bt cotton is commercially cultivated; GM mustard's official materials reviewed here refer to environmental release for seed production/testing under conditions before commercial release.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Bt cotton and GM mustard have identical legal status in India. -> Bt cotton is commercially cultivated; GM mustard's official materials reviewed here refer to environmental release for seed production/testing under conditions before commercial release.

Q73. Answer: A | Science and Technology

With reference to Vaccines, Monoclonal Antibodies and Biopharma, consider the following statements: 1. A vaccine usually works through active immunisation; a monoclonal antibody is a passive/direct biological therapeutic. 2. CDSCO is India's drug and vaccine regulator. 3. Antivirals, vaccines and monoclonal antibodies are broadly the same kind of intervention. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Vaccines, Monoclonal Antibodies and Biopharma; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Vaccine = active immunisation (memory). mAb = passive antibody supply (immediate, temporary). Antiviral = pharmacological inhibition of replication (no immunology involved).

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Antivirals, vaccines and monoclonal antibodies are broadly the same kind of intervention.' and replaces it with 'Vaccine = active immunisation (memory). mAb = passive antibody supply (immediate, temporary). Antiviral = pharmacological inhibition of replication (no immunology involved).'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Antivirals, vaccines and monoclonal antibodies are broadly the same kind of intervention.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Vaccine = active immunisation (memory). mAb = passive antibody supply (immediate, temporary). Antiviral = pharmacological inhibition of replication (no immunology involved).

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Vaccine = active immunisation (memory). mAb = passive antibody supply (immediate, temporary). Antiviral = pharmacological inhibition of replication (no immunology involved).

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Antivirals, vaccines and monoclonal antibodies are broadly the same kind of intervention. -> Vaccine = active immunisation (memory). mAb = passive antibody supply (immediate, temporary). Antiviral = pharmacological inhibition of replication (no immunology involved).

Q74. Answer: B | Science and Technology

With reference to Nanotechnology and Applications, consider the following statements: 1. INST explains nanotechnology as science and technology conducted at the nanoscale of about 1-100 nm. 2. Unique nanoscale behaviour is linked to quantum effects and expanded relative surface area. 3. Graphene and carbon nanotubes are the same material form. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Graphene and carbon nanotubes are the same material form.' and replaces it with 'Both are carbon nanomaterials, but one is a sheet and the other is a tube.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Nanotechnology and Applications; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Both are carbon nanomaterials, but one is a sheet and the other is a tube.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Graphene and carbon nanotubes are the same material form.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Both are carbon nanomaterials, but one is a sheet and the other is a tube.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Both are carbon nanomaterials, but one is a sheet and the other is a tube.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Graphene and carbon nanotubes are the same material form. -> Both are carbon nanomaterials, but one is a sheet and the other is a tube.

Q75. Answer: C | Science and Technology

With reference to Intellectual Property Rights and Patents, consider the following statements: 1. A patent protects an invention; a trademark protects a brand identifier; a GI protects place-linked goods with collective regional character. 2. Patentability in India requires novelty, inventive step and industrial applicability. 3. A GI belongs to one private company like a trademark. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'A GI belongs to one private company like a trademark.' and replaces it with 'A GI is a place-based collective right tied to producer groups and origin.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: A GI belongs to one private company like a trademark.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Intellectual Property Rights and Patents; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: A GI is a place-based collective right tied to producer groups and origin.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: A GI is a place-based collective right tied to producer groups and origin.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: A GI is a place-based collective right tied to producer groups and origin.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: A GI belongs to one private company like a trademark. -> A GI is a place-based collective right tied to producer groups and origin.

Q76. Answer: D | Science and Technology

With reference to Electric Vehicles, Batteries and Alternative Fuels, consider the following statements: 1. A BEV is different from an HEV and a PHEV (only the PHEV can be plugged in), and all three differ from an FCEV. 2. A lithium-ion cell fundamentally involves cathode, anode and electrolyte; NMC/NCA chemistries use cobalt and nickel while LFP does not. 3. Battery chemistry is only about lithium as a raw mineral. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Battery chemistry is only about lithium as a raw mineral.' and replaces it with 'Cathode chemistry decides which minerals matter: LFP uses neither cobalt nor nickel, while NMC/NCA do.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Battery chemistry is only about lithium as a raw mineral.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Cathode chemistry decides which minerals matter: LFP uses neither cobalt nor nickel, while NMC/NCA do.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Electric Vehicles, Batteries and Alternative Fuels; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Cathode chemistry decides which minerals matter: LFP uses neither cobalt nor nickel, while NMC/NCA do.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Cathode chemistry decides which minerals matter: LFP uses neither cobalt nor nickel, while NMC/NCA do.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Battery chemistry is only about lithium as a raw mineral. -> Cathode chemistry decides which minerals matter: LFP uses neither cobalt nor nickel, while NMC/NCA do.

Q77. Answer: A | Science and Technology

With reference to Drones, UAVs and Robotics Policy, consider the following statements: 1. India's official drone categories are nano, micro, small, medium and large based on maximum all-up weight. 2. The thresholds are 250 g, 2 kg, 25 kg and 150 kg as key cut-offs. 3. Civil drone policy automatically covers military UAV systems in full. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Drones, UAVs and Robotics Policy; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Defence UAV issues have a separate operational and procurement context.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Civil drone policy automatically covers military UAV systems in full.' and replaces it with 'Defence UAV issues have a separate operational and procurement context.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Civil drone policy automatically covers military UAV systems in full.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Defence UAV issues have a separate operational and procurement context.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Defence UAV issues have a separate operational and procurement context.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Civil drone policy automatically covers military UAV systems in full. -> Defence UAV issues have a separate operational and procurement context.

Q78. Answer: B | Science and Technology

With reference to Emerging Materials, Rare Earths and Critical Minerals, consider the following statements: 1. Rare earth elements are a specific set of 17 elements; they are not identical to the entire critical-minerals list. 2. The same report includes REE as one of the critical categories and lists individual rare earth elements within it. 3. Rare earths and critical minerals are the same category. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Rare earths and critical minerals are the same category.' and replaces it with 'Rare earths are only one subgroup within the wider critical-minerals policy universe.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Emerging Materials, Rare Earths and Critical Minerals; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Rare earths are only one subgroup within the wider critical-minerals policy universe.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Rare earths and critical minerals are the same category.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Rare earths are only one subgroup within the wider critical-minerals policy universe.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Rare earths are only one subgroup within the wider critical-minerals policy universe.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Rare earths and critical minerals are the same category. -> Rare earths are only one subgroup within the wider critical-minerals policy universe.

Q79. Answer: C | Governance and Security

With reference to Humanitarian Logistics, Relief, Rehabilitation and Recovery, consider the following statements: 1. The DM cycle's three post-disaster phases: relief, rehabilitation, reconstruction (Section 2). 2. The Incident Command System

dates to 2003 and is deactivated once rehabilitation ends; India's own adaptation is the Incident Response System, governed by NDMA's July 2010 guidelines. 3. "ICS" and "IRS" are interchangeable labels in the Indian context. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects "'ICS" and "IRS" are interchangeable labels in the Indian context.' and replaces it with 'VisionIAS describes the generic Incident Command System (2003); India's institutional arrangement is the Incident Response System, governed by NDMA's July 2010 guidelines. Use IRS when naming the Indian structure.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: "ICS" and "IRS" are interchangeable labels in the Indian context.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Humanitarian Logistics, Relief, Rehabilitation and Recovery; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: VisionIAS describes the generic Incident Command System (2003); India's institutional arrangement is the Incident Response System, governed by NDMA's July 2010 guidelines. Use IRS when naming the Indian structure.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: VisionIAS describes the generic Incident Command System (2003); India's institutional arrangement is the Incident Response System, governed by NDMA's July 2010 guidelines. Use IRS when naming the Indian structure.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: VisionIAS describes the generic Incident Command System (2003); India's institutional arrangement is the Incident Response System, governed by NDMA's July 2010 guidelines. Use IRS when naming the Indian structure.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: "ICS" and "IRS" are interchangeable labels in the Indian context. -> VisionIAS describes the generic Incident Command System (2003); India's institutional arrangement is the Incident Response System, governed by NDMA's July 2010 guidelines. Use IRS when naming the Indian structure.

Q80. Answer: D | Governance and Security

With reference to Governance, Capacity and International Cooperation, consider the following statements: 1. The World Conference on Disaster Risk Reduction has been hosted three times, always in Japan: Yokohama (1994), Kobe (2005), Sendai (2015). 2. Hyogo Framework: five priorities, 2005-2015. Sendai Framework: four priorities, seven targets, 2015-2030. 3. The India-hosted-events chronology (2015-2023) and India's membership/cooperation status are current without verification. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The India-hosted-events chronology (2015-2023) and India's membership/cooperation status are current without verification.' and replaces it with 'Treat as document-period chronology; verify current cooperation status against NDMA/MHA/UNDRR sources.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The India-hosted-events chronology (2015-2023) and India's membership/cooperation status are current without verification.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Treat as document-period chronology; verify current cooperation status against NDMA/MHA/UNDRR sources.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Governance, Capacity and International Cooperation; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Treat as document-period chronology; verify current cooperation status against NDMA/MHA/UNDRR sources.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Treat as document-period chronology; verify current cooperation status against NDMA/MHA/UNDRR sources.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The India-hosted-events chronology (2015-2023) and India's membership/cooperation status are current without verification. -> Treat as document-period chronology; verify current cooperation status against NDMA/MHA/UNDRR sources.

Q81. Answer: A | Governance and Security

With reference to Good Governance: Concepts and Frameworks, consider the following statements: 1. Good Governance Day is observed on 25 December, Atal Bihari Vajpayee's birth anniversary, since 2014. 2. GGI grouping changed by edition: three groups in 2019; four in 2020-21 - Other States Group A, Other States Group B, North-East and Hill States, and UTs. 3. The District Good Governance Index (DGGI) is a later national GGI edition. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Good Governance: Concepts and Frameworks; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: DGGI is a separate sub-national exercise developed for particular states/UTs; it does not supersede or substitute for a national GGI edition.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'The District Good Governance Index (DGGI) is a later national GGI edition.' and replaces it with 'DGGI is a separate sub-national exercise developed for particular states/UTs; it does not supersede or substitute for a national GGI edition.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: The District Good Governance Index (DGGI) is a later national GGI edition.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: DGGI is a separate sub-national exercise developed for particular states/UTs; it does not supersede or substitute for a national GGI edition.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: DGGI is a separate sub-national exercise developed for particular states/UTs; it does not supersede or substitute for a national GGI edition.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: The District Good Governance Index (DGGI) is a later national GGI edition. -> DGGI is a separate sub-national exercise developed for particular states/UTs; it does not supersede or substitute for a national GGI edition.

Q82. Answer: B | Governance and Security

With reference to Government Policy Design and Implementation, consider the following statements: 1. The policy cycle's standard stages are agenda setting, formulation, decision, implementation and evaluation, feeding back into agenda setting. 2. Michael Lipsky coined "street-level bureaucracy" to describe frontline officials whose discretion effectively constitutes policy in practice. 3. Consultation before formulation is a purely procedural formality. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Consultation before formulation is a purely procedural formality.' and replaces it with 'Effective pre-legislative consultation and RIA are meant to surface implementation problems before they become costly delivery failures.'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Government Policy Design and Implementation; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Effective pre-legislative consultation and RIA are meant to surface implementation problems before they become costly delivery failures.

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Consultation before formulation is a purely procedural formality.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Effective pre-legislative consultation and RIA are meant to surface implementation problems before they become costly delivery failures.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Effective pre-legislative consultation and RIA are meant to surface implementation problems before they become costly delivery failures.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Consultation before formulation is a purely procedural formality. -> Effective pre-legislative consultation and RIA are meant to surface implementation problems before they become costly delivery failures.

Q83. Answer: C | Governance and Security

With reference to Development Processes and the Development Industry, consider the following statements: 1. The Indian Trusts Act, 1882 is not a uniform governing statute for public charitable endowments; state law, the deed and other applicable charitable/endowment law govern. 2. Section 8 of the Companies Act, 2013 permits incorporation of companies for charitable objects, prohibiting profit distribution to members. 3. Every public charitable trust is incorporated under the Indian Trusts Act, 1882. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Every public charitable trust is incorporated under the Indian Trusts Act, 1882.' and replaces it with 'Section 1 excludes public/private religious or charitable endowments; verify the relevant state public-trust/endowment regime.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Every public charitable trust is incorporated under the Indian Trusts Act, 1882.

C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Development Processes and the Development Industry; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Section 1 excludes public/private religious or charitable endowments; verify the relevant state public-trust/endowment regime.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Section 1 excludes public/private religious or charitable endowments; verify the relevant state public-trust/endowment regime.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Section 1 excludes public/private religious or charitable endowments; verify the relevant state public-trust/endowment regime.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Every public charitable trust is incorporated under the Indian Trusts Act, 1882. -> Section 1 excludes public/private religious or charitable endowments; verify the relevant state public-trust/endowment regime.

Q84. Answer: D | Governance and Security

With reference to NGOs, SHGs and Civil Society Stakeholders, consider the following statements: 1. DAY-NRLM is implemented by the Ministry of Rural Development and predominantly mobilises rural women into SHGs, federated into village organisations and cluster-level federations. 2. FCRA, 2010 (amended 2020) is administered by the Ministry of Home Affairs and mandates registration/prior permission for any association receiving foreign contributions. 3. NGO Darpan registration is legally identical to FCRA registration. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'NGO Darpan registration is legally identical to FCRA registration.' and replaces it with 'NGO Darpan is a NITI Aayog identification/database portal (relevant mainly for government grants); FCRA registration is a separate Ministry of Home Affairs legal requirement specifically for foreign funding.'

B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: NGO Darpan registration is legally identical to FCRA registration.

C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: NGO Darpan is a NITI Aayog identification/database portal (relevant mainly for government grants); FCRA registration is a separate Ministry of Home Affairs legal requirement specifically for foreign funding.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about NGOs, SHGs and Civil Society Stakeholders; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: NGO Darpan is a NITI Aayog identification/database portal (relevant mainly for government grants); FCRA registration is a separate Ministry of Home Affairs legal requirement specifically for foreign funding.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: NGO Darpan is a NITI Aayog identification/database portal (relevant mainly for government grants); FCRA registration is a separate Ministry of Home Affairs legal requirement specifically for foreign funding.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: NGO Darpan registration is legally identical to FCRA registration. -> NGO Darpan is a NITI Aayog identification/database portal (relevant mainly for government grants); FCRA registration is a separate Ministry of Home Affairs legal requirement specifically for foreign funding.

Q85. Answer: A | Governance and Security

With reference to E-Governance Models and User-Centricity, consider the following statements: 1. The five classical e-governance models are Broadcasting, Critical Flow, Comparative Analysis, Mobilisation and Networking, and Interactive Service. 2. NeSDA is administered by DARPG and assesses e-governance service delivery using parameters including accessibility, end-service delivery, integrated service delivery, status tracking, open government data and e-participation. 3. E-governance is only about putting government information online. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about E-Governance Models and User-Centricity; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: That is only the Broadcasting Model; the Interactive Service Model requires full two-way transactional delivery with built-in accountability.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'E-governance is only about putting government information online.' and replaces it with 'That is only the Broadcasting Model; the Interactive Service Model requires full two-way transactional delivery with built-in accountability.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: E-governance is only about putting government information online.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: That is only the Broadcasting Model; the Interactive Service Model requires full two-way transactional delivery with built-in accountability.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: That is only the Broadcasting Model; the Interactive Service Model requires full two-way transactional delivery with built-in accountability.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: E-governance is only about putting government information online. -> That is only the Broadcasting Model; the Interactive Service Model requires full two-way transactional delivery with built-in accountability.

Q86. Answer: B | Governance and Security

With reference to Digital Public Infrastructure and Data Governance, consider the following statements: 1. UPI is operated by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI). 2. Account Aggregators are regulated by the Reserve Bank of India

as a distinct NBFC category (NBFC-AA). 3. Account Aggregators store and can use citizens' financial data themselves. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Account Aggregators store and can use citizens' financial data themselves.' and replaces it with 'The AA framework is explicitly designed so the Account Aggregator is a "consent manager" that facilitates data flow without storing or monetising the underlying data itself.'
- B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Digital Public Infrastructure and Data Governance; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: The AA framework is explicitly designed so the Account Aggregator is a "consent manager" that facilitates data flow without storing or monetising the underlying data itself.
- C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Account Aggregators store and can use citizens' financial data themselves.
- D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: The AA framework is explicitly designed so the Account Aggregator is a "consent manager" that facilitates data flow without storing or monetising the underlying data itself.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: The AA framework is explicitly designed so the Account Aggregator is a "consent manager" that facilitates data flow without storing or monetising the underlying data itself.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Account Aggregators store and can use citizens' financial data themselves. -> The AA framework is explicitly designed so the Account Aggregator is a "consent manager" that facilitates data flow without storing or monetising the underlying data itself.

Q87. Answer: C | Governance and Security

With reference to Citizen-Centric Administration, consider the following statements: 1. Sevottam has three components: Citizens' Charter, Public Grievance Redress Mechanism, and Service Delivery Capability. 2. Madhya Pradesh enacted India's first Right to Public Services Act in 2010, giving specified services a statutory delivery timeline with penalties for default. 3. Governance needs only the portal/RTS machinery, while Ethics alone owns Charter design. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Governance needs only the portal/RTS machinery, while Ethics alone owns Charter design.' and replaces it with 'GS-II Governance requires both quality of the Charter promise and the architecture that delivers/enforces it; Ethics supplies a complementary work-culture lens.'
- B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Governance needs only the portal/RTS machinery, while Ethics alone owns Charter design.
- C. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Citizen-Centric Administration; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: GS-II Governance requires both quality of the Charter promise and the architecture that delivers/enforces it; Ethics supplies a complementary work-culture lens.
- D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: GS-II Governance requires both quality of the Charter promise and the architecture that delivers/enforces it; Ethics supplies a complementary work-culture lens.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: GS-II Governance requires both quality of the Charter promise and the architecture that delivers/enforces it; Ethics supplies a complementary work-culture lens.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Governance needs only the portal/RTS machinery, while Ethics alone owns Charter design. -> GS-II Governance requires both quality of the Charter promise and the architecture that delivers/enforces it; Ethics supplies a complementary work-culture lens.

Q88. Answer: D | Governance and Security

With reference to Transparency, Accountability, RTI, Grievance Redress and Social Audit, consider the following statements: 1. Section 17 of the MGNREGA, 2005 makes social audit of all works under the scheme a statutory requirement, with the Gram Sabha as the designated social-audit body. 2. The 2011 Rules require facilitation by an independent State Social Audit Unit and at least six-monthly audit in every Gram Panchayat. 3. Social audit is a purely voluntary civil-society practice with no legal basis. Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Social audit is a purely voluntary civil-society practice with no legal basis.' and replaces it with 'Under MGNREGA Section 17 and the Meghalaya Act, 2017, social audit is a statutory obligation, not a discretionary civil-society initiative.'
- B. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Social audit is a purely voluntary civil-society practice with no legal basis.
- C. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Under MGNREGA Section 17 and the Meghalaya Act, 2017, social audit is a statutory obligation, not a discretionary civil-society initiative.

D. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Transparency, Accountability, RTI, Grievance Redress and Social Audit; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Under MGNREGA Section 17 and the Meghalaya Act, 2017, social audit is a statutory obligation, not a discretionary civil-society initiative.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Under MGNREGA Section 17 and the Meghalaya Act, 2017, social audit is a statutory obligation, not a discretionary civil-society initiative.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Social audit is a purely voluntary civil-society practice with no legal basis. -> Under MGNREGA Section 17 and the Meghalaya Act, 2017, social audit is a statutory obligation, not a discretionary civil-society initiative.

Q89. Answer: A | Governance and Security

With reference to Civil Services and Mission Karmayogi, consider the following statements: 1. Mission Karmayogi (NPCSCB) was approved by the Union Cabinet on 2 September 2020. 2. The Capacity Building Commission was established to supervise Mission Karmayogi's implementation across ministries. 3. Civil-service neutrality means civil servants have no policy influence. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Civil Services and Mission Karmayogi; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Neutrality means impartial service to any elected government, not the absence of technical/expert input into policy formulation - civil servants can and do shape policy advice.

B. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'Civil-service neutrality means civil servants have no policy influence.' and replaces it with 'Neutrality means impartial service to any elected government, not the absence of technical/expert input into policy formulation - civil servants can and do shape policy advice.'

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: Civil-service neutrality means civil servants have no policy influence.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Neutrality means impartial service to any elected government, not the absence of technical/expert input into policy formulation - civil servants can and do shape policy advice.

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Neutrality means impartial service to any elected government, not the absence of technical/expert input into policy formulation - civil servants can and do shape policy advice.

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: Civil-service neutrality means civil servants have no policy influence. -> Neutrality means impartial service to any elected government, not the absence of technical/expert input into policy formulation - civil servants can and do shape policy advice.

Q90. Answer: B | Governance and Security

With reference to Administrative Reforms and the 2nd ARC, consider the following statements: 1. The First ARC (1966-1970) was initially chaired by Morarji Desai and later by K. Hanumanthaiah. 2. The Second ARC was constituted in 2005 and chaired by M. Veerappa Moily. 3. All 15 Second ARC reports are equally central to GS-II. Which of the statements given above are correct?

A. 1 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: this combination accepts statement 3, but the cited source explicitly rejects 'All 15 Second ARC reports are equally central to GS-II.' and replaces it with 'Reports on crisis management, public order and counter-terrorism sit mainly in the GS-III internal-security/disaster- management space; GS-II's core Second ARC reports are those routed to Topics 04, 05, 07, 09, 12 and 13 above (plus Ethics' ownership of Report 4).'

B. 1 and 2 only - CORRECT: Correct: statements 1 and 2 reproduce source-grounded facts about Administrative Reforms and the 2nd ARC; statement 3 is the source's explicit trap, corrected as follows: Reports on crisis management, public order and counter-terrorism sit mainly in the GS-III internal-security/disaster- management space; GS-II's core Second ARC reports are those routed to Topics 04, 05, 07, 09, 12 and 13 above (plus Ethics' ownership of Report 4).

C. 2 and 3 only - INCORRECT: Incorrect: statement 1 is also source-grounded, while statement 3 is the rejected trap: All 15 Second ARC reports are equally central to GS-II.

D. 1, 2 and 3 - INCORRECT: Incorrect: all three cannot be correct because statement 3 contradicts the source correction: Reports on crisis management, public order and counter-terrorism sit mainly in the GS-III internal-security/disaster- management space; GS-II's core Second ARC reports are those routed to Topics 04, 05, 07, 09, 12 and 13 above (plus Ethics' ownership of Report 4).

Method / explanation: Statements 1 and 2 are correct. Statement 3 is false: Reports on crisis management, public order and counter-terrorism sit mainly in the GS-III internal-security/disaster- management space; GS-II's core Second ARC reports are those routed to Topics 04, 05, 07, 09, 12 and 13 above (plus Ethics' ownership of Report 4).

Trap: The difficult distractor preserves topic vocabulary but crosses the exact boundary recorded by the source: All 15 Second ARC reports are equally central to GS-II. -> Reports on crisis management, public order and counter-terrorism sit mainly in the GS-III internal-security/disaster- management space; GS-II's core Second ARC reports are those routed to Topics 04, 05, 07, 09, 12 and 13

above (plus Ethics' ownership of Report 4).

Q91. Answer: C | Current Affairs

Consider the following pairs concerning Union Budget 2026-27 (1 February 2026): 1. Dated fact - The Union Budget 2026-27 followed the Economic Survey on 1 February 2026. 2. Responsible institution/process - Ministry of Finance and Parliament 3. Static interpretation - The Annual Financial Statement is constitutionally linked to Article 112. How many of the above pairs preserve the correct fact, institution and status?

- A. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: more than one pair is correct; the option discards valid institutional and conceptual linkages.
- B. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the third pair is also correct because it prevents a status or category error.
- C. All three - CORRECT: Correct: the dated official record supports the fact, identifies the responsible institution or process and states the qualified static interpretation.
- D. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: each pair is supported by the dated official record.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The Union Budget 2026-27 followed the Economic Survey on 1 February 2026. [Analysis] The Annual Financial Statement is constitutionally linked to Article 112.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q92. Answer: D | Current Affairs

Consider the following pairs concerning Economic Survey 2025-26 (29 January 2026): 1. Dated fact - The Economic Survey 2025-26 was tabled in Parliament on 29 January 2026. 2. Responsible institution/process - Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance 3. Static interpretation - The Survey is a policy and analytical document, not a constitutional money bill. How many of the above pairs preserve the correct fact, institution and status?

- A. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: more than one pair is correct; the option discards valid institutional and conceptual linkages.
- B. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the third pair is also correct because it prevents a status or category error.
- C. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: each pair is supported by the dated official record.
- D. All three - CORRECT: Correct: the dated official record supports the fact, identifies the responsible institution or process and states the qualified static interpretation.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The Economic Survey 2025-26 was tabled in Parliament on 29 January 2026. [Analysis] The Survey is a policy and analytical document, not a constitutional money bill.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q93. Answer: A | Current Affairs

Consider the following pairs concerning Economic Survey growth assessment (29 January 2026): 1. Dated fact - The Economic Survey placed FY 2025-26 real GDP growth at 7.4% FAE and projected FY 2026-27 growth at 6.8-7.2%. 2. Responsible institution/process - Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance 3. Static interpretation - A Survey projection is a dated analytical estimate, not a guaranteed outcome. How many of the above pairs preserve the correct fact, institution and status?

- A. All three - CORRECT: Correct: the dated official record supports the fact, identifies the responsible institution or process and states the qualified static interpretation.
- B. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: more than one pair is correct; the option discards valid institutional and conceptual linkages.
- C. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the third pair is also correct because it prevents a status or category error.
- D. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: each pair is supported by the dated official record.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The Economic Survey placed FY 2025-26 real GDP growth at 7.4% FAE and projected FY 2026-27 growth at 6.8-7.2%. [Analysis] A Survey projection is a dated analytical estimate, not a guaranteed outcome.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q94. Answer: B | Current Affairs

Consider the following pairs concerning RBI macro-risk assessment (5 August 2026): 1. Dated fact - RBI's 5 August 2026 statement flagged volatile oil, sticky global inflation, elevated yields, US-dollar strength and uneven monsoon risk. 2. Responsible institution/process - Reserve Bank of India 3. Static interpretation - External shocks affect inflation, growth, fiscal costs and the balance of payments through different transmission channels. How many of the above pairs preserve the correct fact, institution and status?

- A. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: more than one pair is correct; the option discards valid institutional and conceptual linkages.
- B. All three - CORRECT: Correct: the dated official record supports the fact, identifies the responsible institution or process and states the qualified static interpretation.
- C. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the third pair is also correct because it prevents a status or category error.
- D. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: each pair is supported by the dated official record.

Method / explanation: [Fact] RBI's 5 August 2026 statement flagged volatile oil, sticky global inflation, elevated yields, US-dollar strength and uneven monsoon risk. [Analysis] External shocks affect inflation, growth, fiscal costs and the balance of payments through different transmission channels.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q95. Answer: C | Current Affairs

Consider the following pairs concerning India's 100th Ramsar site milestone (5 June 2026): 1. Dated fact - India reached 100 Ramsar sites on 5 June 2026, with Surha Tal in Ballia district recorded as the 100th site. 2. Responsible institution/process - MoEFCC and the Ramsar Convention framework 3. Static interpretation - Ramsar designation recognises a Wetland of International Importance but does not by itself prove management effectiveness. How many of the above pairs preserve the correct fact, institution and status?

- A. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: more than one pair is correct; the option discards valid institutional and conceptual linkages.
- B. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the third pair is also correct because it prevents a status or category error.
- C. All three - CORRECT: Correct: the dated official record supports the fact, identifies the responsible institution or process and states the qualified static interpretation.
- D. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: each pair is supported by the dated official record.

Method / explanation: [Fact] India reached 100 Ramsar sites on 5 June 2026, with Surha Tal in Ballia district recorded as the 100th site. [Analysis] Ramsar designation recognises a Wetland of International Importance but does not by itself prove management effectiveness.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q96. Answer: D | Current Affairs

Consider the following pairs concerning Non-fossil installed-capacity milestone (31 December 2025): 1. Dated fact - Non-fossil sources accounted for 51.93% of India's installed power capacity at end-December 2025. 2. Responsible institution/process - Ministry of Power data cited by Economic Survey 2025-26 3. Static interpretation - Installed capacity share is not the same as electricity-generation share or energy-consumption share. How many of the above pairs preserve the correct fact, institution and status?

- A. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: more than one pair is correct; the option discards valid institutional and conceptual linkages.
- B. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the third pair is also correct because it prevents a status or category error.
- C. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: each pair is supported by the dated official record.
- D. All three - CORRECT: Correct: the dated official record supports the fact, identifies the responsible institution or process and states the qualified static interpretation.

Method / explanation: [Fact] Non-fossil sources accounted for 51.93% of India's installed power capacity at end-December 2025. [Analysis] Installed capacity share is not the same as electricity-generation share or energy-consumption share.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q97. Answer: A | Current Affairs

Consider the following pairs concerning Renewable-capacity addition (31 December 2025): 1. Dated fact - India added 38.61 GW of renewable capacity in 2025-26 up to 31 December 2025, according to the Economic Survey evidence card. 2. Responsible institution/process - MNRE data cited by Economic Survey 2025-26 3. Static interpretation - Capacity added is a flow over a period; installed capacity is a stock at a date. How many of the above pairs preserve the correct fact, institution and status?

- A. All three - CORRECT: Correct: the dated official record supports the fact, identifies the responsible institution or process and states the qualified static interpretation.
- B. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: more than one pair is correct; the option discards valid institutional and conceptual linkages.
- C. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the third pair is also correct because it prevents a status or category error.

D. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: each pair is supported by the dated official record.

Method / explanation: [Fact] India added 38.61 GW of renewable capacity in 2025-26 up to 31 December 2025, according to the Economic Survey evidence card. [Analysis] Capacity added is a flow over a period; installed capacity is a stock at a date.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q98. Answer: B | Current Affairs

Consider the following pairs concerning Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex (21 June 2026): 1. Dated fact - PIB material recorded the Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex as under construction on 21 June 2026. 2. Responsible institution/process - Department of Space and ISRO 3. Static interpretation - An approved or under-construction launch facility is not an operational facility. How many of the above pairs preserve the correct fact, institution and status?

A. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: more than one pair is correct; the option discards valid institutional and conceptual linkages.

B. All three - CORRECT: Correct: the dated official record supports the fact, identifies the responsible institution or process and states the qualified static interpretation.

C. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the third pair is also correct because it prevents a status or category error.

D. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: each pair is supported by the dated official record.

Method / explanation: [Fact] PIB material recorded the Kulasekarapattinam SSLV launch complex as under construction on 21 June 2026. [Analysis] An approved or under-construction launch facility is not an operational facility.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q99. Answer: C | Current Affairs

Consider the following pairs concerning India's BRICS 2026 chairship launch (13 January 2026): 1. Dated fact - India launched the BRICS 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026; this did not establish that a Leaders' Summit had already been completed. 2. Responsible institution/process - Ministry of External Affairs and the BRICS chairship process 3. Static interpretation - Chairship-process activity and a concluded summit outcome are distinct statuses. How many of the above pairs preserve the correct fact, institution and status?

A. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: more than one pair is correct; the option discards valid institutional and conceptual linkages.

B. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the third pair is also correct because it prevents a status or category error.

C. All three - CORRECT: Correct: the dated official record supports the fact, identifies the responsible institution or process and states the qualified static interpretation.

D. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: each pair is supported by the dated official record.

Method / explanation: [Fact] India launched the BRICS 2026 chairship theme, logo and website on 13 January 2026; this did not establish that a Leaders' Summit had already been completed. [Analysis] Chairship-process activity and a concluded summit outcome are distinct statuses.

Trap: Do not convert a dated executive, diplomatic or scientific event into a different legal category.

Q100. Answer: D | Current Affairs

Consider the following pairs concerning BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement (16 May 2026): 1. Dated fact - The BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement entered into force on 16 May 2026 among Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, the four states then recorded as having deposited instruments. 2. Responsible institution/process - BIMSTEC treaty and depositary process 3. Static interpretation - Entry into force among depositing states should not be described as binding every member automatically. How many of the above pairs preserve the correct fact, institution and status?

A. Only one - INCORRECT: Incorrect: more than one pair is correct; the option discards valid institutional and conceptual linkages.

B. Only two - INCORRECT: Incorrect: the third pair is also correct because it prevents a status or category error.

C. None - INCORRECT: Incorrect: each pair is supported by the dated official record.

D. All three - CORRECT: Correct: the dated official record supports the fact, identifies the responsible institution or process and states the qualified static interpretation.

Method / explanation: [Fact] The BIMSTEC maritime transport agreement entered into force on 16 May 2026 among Bhutan, India, Myanmar and Thailand, the four states then recorded as having deposited instruments. [Analysis] Entry into force among depositing states should not be described as binding every member automatically.

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END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS